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About this report

Reporting framework and standards

This Report has been prepared in accordance with the reporting requirements for companies listed on the Abu Dhabi Securities Exchange (ADX), under the supervision of the Securities and Commodities Authority (SCA). Taking into consideration global best practices and industry trends.

This Report has also been made with reference to the following standards and frameworks:

- GRI 2021 Standards
- <IR> Framework of the International Financial Reporting Standards (IFRS) Foundation
- United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (UN SDGs)
- The International Sustainability Standards Board (ISSB) Standards (Working Towards)

Forward-looking statement

This report contains forward-looking information, including “future-oriented financial information” and “financial outlook,” as defined by applicable securities laws. Aside from historical facts, it may include forward-looking statements reflecting management’s views. While these are based on reasonable assumptions, actual outcomes may vary. The company assumes no obligation to update forward-looking statements unless mandated by securities laws. Readers are advised to exercise caution and avoid placing undue reliance on these statements.



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e& at [eand.com](https://www.eand.com)



For more information on Sustainability
see www.eand.com/en/sustainability

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Our approach to sustainability

A year of turning ambition into action



In 2024, we moved beyond commitments to real action, deploying transformative technologies to deliver on our sustainability targets and empower the communities we serve.

After setting ambitious environmental targets for 2030, we launched the e& Group Climate Transition Plan, titled “Ambition to Action”. This plan outlines the steps e& will take to achieve its Net Zero Targets. As one of the first companies in the region to publish such a detailed approach, the plan presents our clear roadmap to 2030 and outlines the efforts we are making for the millions of customers we serve, who experience the immediate impacts of climate change. This significant undertaking, involving all markets, gives us confidence that we are on track to deliver. In 2025, for the first time, we will have an independent third party verify or audit our emissions data. The purpose of this external assurance is set to ensure the accuracy, reliability, and transparency of our reported emissions and to maintain our focus on these efforts.

As a global tech company, we recognize that digitisation plays a crucial role in achieving the UN Sustainable Development Goals, ensuring that no one is left behind. In 2024, we deployed our technology to

support several critical partnerships, empowering society through our networks and products. Through the Edison Alliance, we enabled an additional 30 million people to access network services, contributing to the 1 billion target that has now been met. In collaboration with the United Nations Development Programme, we are co-developing the Climate & Natural Disaster Crises (CNDC) Platform, which is designed to enhance resilience against climate-related challenges such as floods, earthquakes, and droughts through AI-powered insights and data visualisation tools. We understand more than ever that digital technology forms the base of the pyramid for tackling some of humanity’s most pressing issues. As our company continues to grow, we will build partnerships focused on transformative solutions using AI, our technology, and our expertise.

As highlighted in the enclosed report, we have made strides this year in our non-financial reporting, reviewing our policies and climate-related risks, among other advancements that are often unseen but critical to our ambition to lead in sustainability and ESG.



One of the first in the region to publish a detailed Climate Transition Plan - turning ambition into action for a sustainable future.”

Hatem Dowidar

Group Chief Executive Officer

Our approach to sustainability continued

Our approach to sustainability

At e&, sustainability is a strategic driver of long-term value creation, deeply embedded in our corporate vision and transformation journey. As a forward-thinking technology and investment group, we recognise that managing our environmental, social, and governance (ESG) impact is not just about mitigating risks – it is about seizing opportunities that drive sustainable growth, enhance resilience, and create lasting value for our stakeholders.

Our approach is structured around three key pillars: Managing our environmental footprint, Empowering people and giving back to society, and Operating responsibly. These pillars address the material challenges that matter most to our stakeholders – as confirmed and refined by a double materiality assessment conducted this year – and underpin our commitment to responsible and ethical business practices.

This sustainability framework is aligned with national and global priorities, including the “We The Emirates 2031” Vision, the Abu Dhabi Economic Vision 2030 and Environment Vision 2030, and the UAE Net Zero Plan 2050. As we advance our sustainability strategy, we continue to align our impact with the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), refining our contributions to maximise our effectiveness.

Transparency is fundamental to our sustainability agenda. We are committed to rigorous ESG reporting in line with international frameworks such as GRI, SASB, and the WEF Stakeholder Capitalism Metrics, while adhering to the Abu Dhabi Securities

Exchange (ADX) voluntary ESG disclosures. By maintaining the highest standards of non-financial reporting, we provide investors with clear, credible insights into our performance and impact.

This report is structured around our 15 material topics – key issues that have been identified as areas in which e& can create the greatest impact. Responsibility for these issues is distributed across multiple departments, ensuring sustainability is embedded across our operations and decision-making. By working collaboratively, each department contributes to managing and delivering on our material topics, driving a unified and effective approach. As we continue to evolve, our sustainability ambition remains unwavering: to drive positive change, align with global best practices, and reinforce our position as a sustainable market leader championing the ambitions of our business and stakeholders.

Our ESG ratings

Rated A

MSCI
in 2024

Rated B

CDP
in 2024

Pillar 1

Managing our environmental footprint



We are dedicated to building a sustainable, inclusive future by embracing adaptability, resilience, and innovation, as we work towards net zero emissions, minimise waste, and invest in renewable energy and climate-smart solutions to leave a positive legacy for future generations.

Material issues:

- Climate action
- Waste management and circularity
- Water usage

Aligned To SDGs:



Discover more about how we are managing our environmental footprint:

Launching our Climate Transition Plan: Ambition to Action



Read more on page 9

Implementing a seamless recycling system for waste reduction with Reloop



Read more on page 18

Pillar 2

Empowering people and giving back to society



We embrace an interconnected framework where economic, social, and environmental priorities align, empowering our talented employees and leveraging innovation to drive meaningful impact and sustainable success beyond traditional metrics.

Material issues

- Diversity, equity and inclusion
- Talent attraction, retention and development
- Health and safety
- Community engagement

Aligned To SDGs:



Discover more about how we are empowering people and giving back to society:

Driving financial inclusion in Pakistan and Egypt



Read more on page 34

Embedding One& Culture transformative initiative to foster employee engagement



Read more on page 30

Pillar 3

Operating responsibly



We lead with responsibility by embedding sustainability into our operations, fostering trust through transparent reporting, and aligning our practices with shared objectives for a more inclusive, resilient, and environmentally sustainable future.

Material issues:

- Ethical business
- Data privacy
- Cybersecurity
- Responsible AI
- Supply chain engagement
- Human rights
- Responsible commercialisation

Aligned To SDGs:



Discover more about how we are operating responsibly:

Leveraging AI for sustainable development and humanitarian impact



Read more on page 55

Pioneering responsible sourcing through EcoVadis with Project Life



Read more on page 58

Q&A with Senior VP, Sustainability

How does e&'s new Climate Transition Plan support the UAE's Net Zero 2050 Strategy?

The UAE's leadership in hosting COP28 has invigorated global efforts towards achieving net zero, and e& is proud to contribute meaningfully to this momentum through our commitments and actions, in particular our recently launched Group-wide Climate Transition Plan. This plan, Ambition to Action, reflects a rigorous and unified approach across our operations, designed to support the UAE's ambitious target of net zero by 2050 while aligning with global benchmarks.

Our commitment to eliminate Scope 1 and 2 emissions in the UAE by 2030 underscores our proactive stance. The plan identifies three primary levers for achieving these targets:

procuring 100% of our electricity in the UAE from renewable sources, adopting sustainable practices such as solar and battery integration for base stations and accelerating the electrification of our fleet. These measures are backed by comprehensive, country-specific roadmaps developed collaboratively with our markets, ensuring practicality and precision.

Beyond operational efficiency, our Scope 3 strategy addresses emissions across our value chain. Through partnerships with suppliers holding Science-Based Targets Initiative (SBTi) approvals and leveraging investments like Vodafone's advanced sustainability trajectory, we aim to reduce emissions while promoting industry-wide progress.

The plan is much more than an internal focusing tool – it is a demonstration of our intent to lead in sustainable innovation. As one of the first companies in the region to publish such a detailed roadmap, we hope to set a benchmark for corporate accountability and action.

What were your biggest achievements in 2024?

Throughout the year, we concentrated on laying a strong foundation for sustainability at e& by closing critical gaps, enhancing transparency and building capacity across the Group. Over the past 18 months, we identified 19 areas of improvement across environmental, social and governance (ESG) pillars, and we successfully addressed all of them. This effort was central to establishing a coordinated, group-wide approach to ESG.

Furthermore, we prioritised creating a cohesive sustainability framework by fostering a collaborative community across our operating companies. Through regular engagements, we are building a culture of accountability and shared commitment, enabling every function and business unit to contribute meaningfully to our sustainability goals. The launch of our Climate Transition Plan further provided clarity of focus internally about how we will achieve our shared ambitions.

Stakeholder expectations for transparent reporting have increased across Europe with the introduction of the CSRD. What are your plans to reach compliance across your European operations?

At e&, we are fully committed to meeting the Corporate Sustainability Reporting Directive (CSRD) requirements across our European operations and leveraging this momentum to elevate our reporting standards globally.

Following the acquisition of PPF Telecom Group, we have inherited a robust sustainability function that has been preparing for CSRD compliance. Their 2023 report aligned with CSRD standards and they have rigorously tested their reporting systems against these requirements.

Recognising the broader implications for our Group, we are conducting a comprehensive CSRD and IFRS gap analysis to identify and address any potential shortcomings across our portfolio, including our listed entities like Maroc Telecom. This initiative is part of our strategy to align our reporting practices with international standards and ensure consistency and accuracy. Our approach to CSRD compliance is not confined to meeting legislative requirements; it is an opportunity to raise the bar for sustainability reporting across all our markets.

Looking ahead, what are your key priorities for 2025?

This year, we aim to deepen our strategy with a refreshed sustainability framework anchored in

clear goals for both environmental and social domains. One of our priorities is understanding and quantifying the full social impact of our operations globally – from empowering financial inclusion to enabling digital transformation – ensuring our efforts directly contribute to the communities we serve.

In line with this, we are launching “e& Community”, an initiative that unifies our CSR efforts under three core pillars: leveraging technology for people, the planet and innovation. This strategic consolidation will allow us to scale our impact, focusing on fewer, high-value initiatives that drive measurable outcomes.

Moreover, we are committed to enhancing transparency and accountability in our sustainability efforts. For the first time, we will externally assure our greenhouse gas (GHG) data, re-baseline our emissions across the Group and implement a cutting-edge GHG data management tool to refine our data accuracy and reporting.

As a global tech company, we know our technology has the power to transform and change the way we live for the better. Wherever we operate, digital is the base of the pyramid for addressing some of the most pressing problems in the communities in which we operate. Our sustainability programmes will continue to lead us in meeting our environmental and social commitments and improve lives of many in the communities in which we serve.

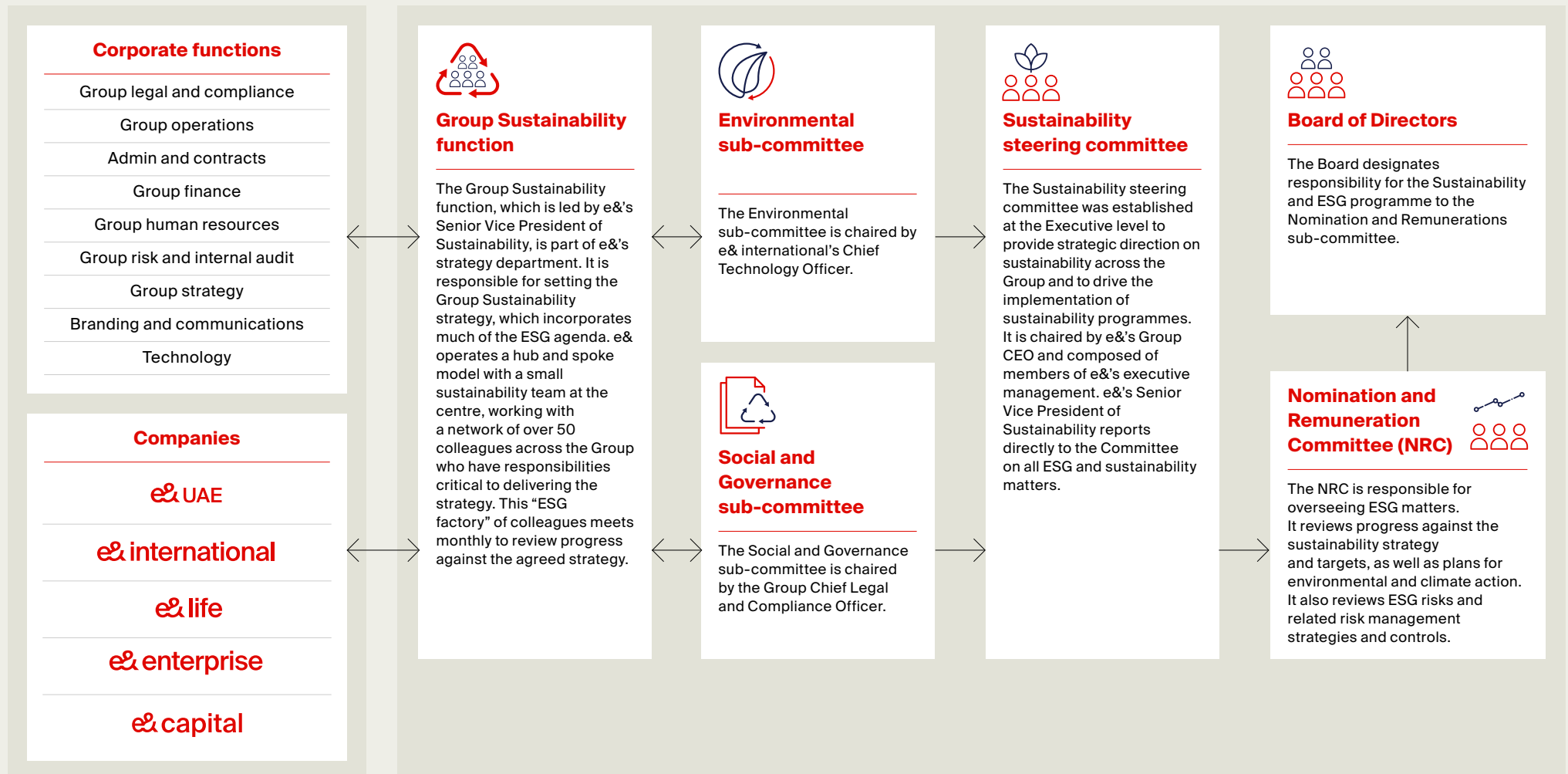
Andrew Dunnett
Group Senior Vice President
of Sustainability



ESG Governance 2024

Integration of ESG across our business

We recognise that effective ESG governance is fundamental to driving long-term value and ensuring the successful integration of sustainability across our business. Our governance framework is designed to provide oversight, accountability, and strategic direction for ESG-related initiatives, ensuring alignment with our corporate strategy and stakeholder expectations.



Double materiality

In 2024, we conducted our first double materiality assessment to identify and prioritise the most significant environmental, social, and governance (ESG) topics impacting both e& and its stakeholders.

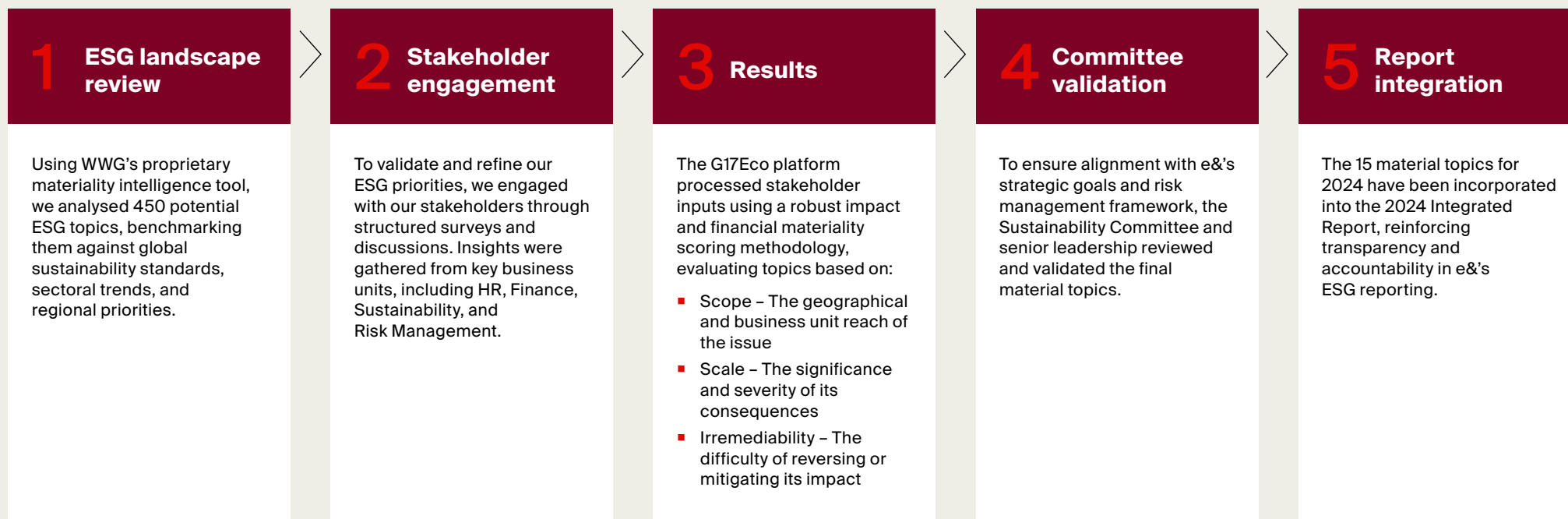
This assessment aligns with international reporting frameworks, including the Global Reporting Initiative (GRI) and the upcoming Corporate Sustainability Reporting Directive (CSRD) requirements.

Leveraging e& enterprise's "Sustainability as a Service", we collaborated with World Wide Generation (WWG) to utilise its G17Eco platform, enabling a data-

driven analysis of 450 ESG topics. By integrating stakeholder input, industry benchmarks, and regional considerations, we ensured a balanced evaluation of financial and impact materiality. The final list of 15 material topics now serves as a foundation for e&'s sustainability commitments, initiatives, and reporting practices.

Materiality assessment process

Our assessment followed a five-step process, ensuring a comprehensive and strategic approach to materiality.



Double materiality continued

Materiality results

We have refined our material topics from 18 in 2023 to 15 in 2024, incorporating emerging trends, consolidating overlapping topics, and aligning with evolving ESG priorities.

The 15 material topics below were identified through our materiality assessment process, classified as material based on a defined threshold evaluating both impact materiality (societal and environmental significance) and financial materiality (business risk and opportunity). A topic is considered material if it meets or exceeds this threshold.

Pillar 1 Managing our environmental footprint



Impact Financial

- | | Impact | Financial |
|-------------------------------------|--------|-----------|
| 1. Climate action | ✓ | |
| 2. Waste management and circularity | ✓ | |
| 3. Water usage | ✓ | |

[→](#) Read more on page 9

Pillar 2 Empowering people and giving back to society



Impact Financial

- | | Impact | Financial |
|---|--------|-----------|
| 4. Diversity, equity and inclusion | ✓ | |
| 5. Talent attraction, retention and development | ✓ | ✓ |
| 6. Digital access and inclusion | ✓ | |
| 7. Health and safety | ✓ | |
| 8. Community engagement | | ✓ |

[→](#) Read more on page 24

Pillar 3 Operating responsibly



Impact Financial

- | | Impact | Financial |
|-----------------------------------|--------|-----------|
| 9. Ethical business practices | ✓ | ✓ |
| 10. Data privacy | ✓ | |
| 11. Cybersecurity | ✓ | |
| 12. Responsible AI | ✓ | ✓ |
| 13. Sustainable supply chain | | ✓ |
| 14. Human rights | ✓ | |
| 15. Responsible commercialisation | | ✓ |

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Our material topics

Focusing on what matters, this report is aligned with our 15 material topics – critical issues identified through our double materiality assessment. These topics highlight the areas where e& is best positioned to drive meaningful progress.

Pillar 1

Managing our environmental footprint



1. Climate action	9
2. Waste management and circularity	18
3. Water usage	22

Pillar 2

Empowering people and giving back to society



4. Diversity, equity and inclusion	24
5. Talent attraction, retention and development	29
6. Digital access and inclusion	32
7. Health and safety	36
8. Community engagement	39

Pillar 3

Operating responsibly



9. Ethical business practices	43
10. Data privacy	47
11. Cybersecurity	50
12. Responsible AI	52
13. Sustainable supply chain	56
14. Human rights	59
15. Responsible commercialisation	61

Pillar 1 | Managing our environmental footprint

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13 14 15

1 Climate action



We have taken bold and decisive steps this year in our journey towards achieving net zero with the publication of our Climate Transition Plan: Ambition to Action. This roadmap outlines how we will meet our ambitious Scope 1, 2, and 3 targets, and reinforces our commitment to embedding sustainability across every facet of our operations. By implementing innovative solutions, fostering collaboration, and addressing key climate risks, we are driving measurable progress in reducing emissions, optimising energy use, and integrating renewable energy sources. Through a steadfast focus on governance and transparency, we aim to create lasting value for our stakeholders while playing a pivotal role in shaping a more sustainable and resilient future.”

Sabri Ali Yehya

Group Chief Technology Officer, e& International

Definition of material matter:

Our carbon footprint is the entire amount of greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions resulting from our activities, both directly and indirectly, expressed in carbon dioxide equivalents. It includes emissions from a range of sources, such as energy use, purchased goods and services or capital goods.

Why it is material to e&:

e& operates in regions affected by extreme weather conditions, exacerbated by climate change. Mitigation and adaptation strategies are essential to preserve water, biodiversity and food security as well as to preserve our business continuity, threatened by extreme weather conditions. With growing consumer demand for sustainable products and services, we believe reducing our carbon footprint is a business necessity.

Type of impact:

Implementing carbon reduction strategies aligns with global sustainability goals, positively impacting the environment and society. Investing in sustainable practices presents opportunities for innovation, cost savings and enhanced brand reputation. Failure to manage and reduce our carbon footprint poses a risk to our

environmental credibility, regulatory compliance, and stakeholder relationships and business continuity.

Value chain impact:

- Upstream
- Operations
- Downstream

Key stakeholders:

- Customers
- Employees
- Business partners
- Shareholders
- Community
- Local and national authorities

Targets

- Achieve net zero emissions (Scope 1 and 2) across all our markets by 2040 (UAE 2030)
- Achieve net zero emissions (Scope 1, 2 and 3) across all our markets by 2050
- 43% reduction in Scope 1 and 2 across all our markets by 2030 versus the 2022 baseline – SBTi validated
- 25% reduction in Scope 3 across all our markets by 2030 versus the 2022 baseline – SBTi validated

Our management approach

At e&, addressing climate change begins with a comprehensive understanding of our carbon footprint, guided by widely recognised standards and methodologies. Our emissions accounting framework aligns with the Greenhouse Gas Protocol and leverages emission factors from DEFRA, the US EPA, and the IEA. By considering both direct and indirect emissions across our value chain and operating companies, we take a holistic view of our environmental impact, enabling us to measure, mitigate, and manage emissions across our business ecosystem.

Our governance structure is designed to align with international best practices, allowing us to set ambitious targets and pursue a net zero future across all operations. This commitment extends beyond compliance, reflecting our dedication to environmental responsibility and stewardship. Addressing climate-related challenges requires a coordinated effort across multiple divisions. The e& International technology team leads the Group's carbon reduction initiatives, working closely with the Sustainability team to implement and monitor progress. Climate-related risks and opportunities are collaboratively managed by our Enterprise Risk Management (ERM) team and Sustainability function.

[→ Continues](#)

Pillar 1 | Managing our environmental footprint

Climate action continued

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The governance framework ensures rigorous oversight and accountability. The Board's Nomination and Remuneration Committee (NRC) approves the Sustainability Strategy, while the Sustainability Committee oversees programme execution to meet strategic objectives. The Senior Vice President of Sustainability reports quarterly to the Sustainability Committee on progress against targets. Green finance initiatives are spearheaded by the Corporate Finance team, supported by cross-functional collaboration involving the Legal, Sustainability, Procurement, and e& International Technology teams.

All climate-related commitments undergo a robust approval process, which includes review by the CXO of the relevant department, the Sustainability Committee, and the Group CEO. The NRC of the Board of Directors provides strategic oversight, ensuring our climate strategy is fully integrated into our broader goals and responsibilities. This cohesive approach underscores our dedication to combating climate change while driving sustainable value for all stakeholders.

Progress in 2024

We made significant strides in advancing our sustainability agenda and meeting our ambitious net zero targets for 2030. Central to this progress was the publication of our Climate Transition Plan: Ambition to Action (CTP), a publicly accessible roadmap detailing how we will achieve our Scope 1, 2, and 3 GHG reduction targets. A climate risk analysis was also completed, which included creating a risk registry, quantifying top transition risks, and prioritising three risks for action.

Key milestones included publishing targets on circularity for the first time and committing to programmes addressing water management and biodiversity. In addition, we developed a carbon reduction roadmap with a primary focus on Scope 1 and Scope 2 emissions. Initiatives to optimise energy use, reduce fuel consumption, and integrate renewable energy were successfully implemented. In Egypt, we achieved 17% renewable energy usage through a Power Purchase Agreement, and in the UAE by purchasing IRECs to support the energy transition.

Operational improvements further bolstered emissions reductions. In the UAE, 400 diesel generators were decommissioned, while Egypt deployed over 2,500 remote monitoring solutions and Afghanistan launched a trial using a super capacitor to provide reliable power during outages with 112 sites implementing this solution reducing energy consumption by 604,000 litres of fuel per year. Across 886 sites in the UAE, we adopted free air

Our global carbon footprint based on our 2022 baseline



cooling and began replacing refrigerants with lower Global Warming Potential (GWP) alternatives. Additionally, fleet electrification advanced in the UAE, where 102 electric vehicles are now in operation.

Overcoming challenges required building a cohesive global team to lead these initiatives and enlisting external advisors to navigate regulatory approvals and market maturity for renewable energy certificates.

→ Continues

Pillar 1 | Managing our environmental footprint

Climate action continued

Ambition to action: e&'s Climate Transition Plan

Recognising the urgency of climate action, this year we took a bold step to be industry leaders within the region and launched our Climate Transition Plan (CTP). The plan clearly lays out how we will achieve net zero emissions for Scope 1 and 2 by 2030 within our UAE operation and Group-wide Scope 1, 2 and 3 net zero emissions by 2050.

Our ambitious near-term targets have been validated by the Science Based Targets initiative (SBTi) to ensure measurable and impactful progress and include reducing Scope 1 and 2 GHG emissions by 43% Group-wide and achieving a 25% reduction in Scope 3 emissions by 2030, all benchmarked against a 2022 baseline.

Our CTP incorporates a roadmap designed to address the unique market characteristics of the regions where we operate, including the UAE, Egypt, Pakistan, Afghanistan, and Morocco. By leveraging collaboration

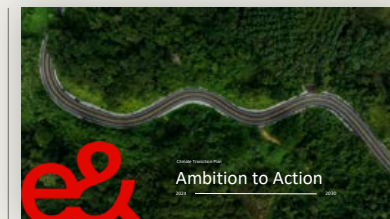
between local strategy, technology, and sustainability teams, we are tackling challenges like data traffic growth and network expansion while maintaining our focus on decarbonisation. Our approach integrates three strategic pillars: decarbonising our operations, transitioning our value chain, and managing climate-related risks.

Aligned with the UK Transition Plan Taskforce's Disclosure Framework, our CTP is a benchmark for best practices in climate transition.

We are committed to transparency and will continue to report on our progress through our Integrated Annual Report, submissions to the Carbon Disclosure Project (CDP), and an update to our CTP scheduled for 2026. These efforts underscore our dedication to achieving climate targets and driving long-term value for our stakeholders.

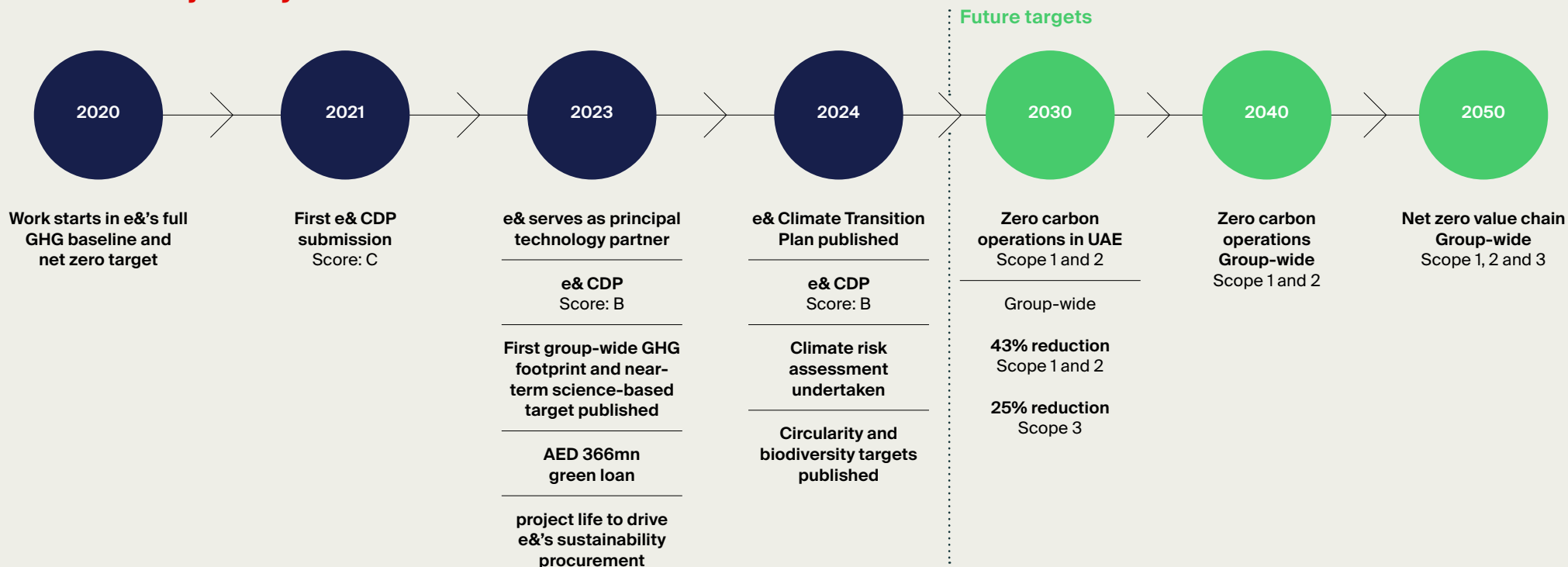
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Read more here
eand.com/content/dam/eand/assets/docs/general/eand-climate-transition-plan.pdf

Our net zero journey



Pillar 1 | Managing our environmental footprint

Climate action continued

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Our climate action plan



Scope 1 and 2

Action areas

Invest in renewable energy generation and purchasing

Continue with fleet electrification

Improve free cooling and gas replacement

Offset remaining emissions through credible projects

Current targets 2024–2030

Emission reduction

↓ **43%**

Target against 2022 baseline

Future targets 2030–2040

Emission reduction

↓ **90%**

Offsets

10%



Scope 3

Action areas

Collaborate with our supply chain to decarbonise purchased goods and services, capital goods and products we sell to our customers

Engage investors and set challenging M&A carbon reduction targets

Invest in digital data management to accurately track performance

Offset remaining emissions through credible projects

Current targets 2024–2030

Emission reduction

↓ **25%**

Target against 2022 baseline

Future targets 2030–2050

Emission reduction

↓ **90%**

Offsets

10%

Pillar 1 | Managing our environmental footprint

Climate action continued

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13 14 15

Decarbonisation goals

Focused on Scope 1 and 2 Decarbonisation Goals

Our CTP outlines six strategies to decarbonise our most carbon intensive Scope 1 and 2 activities, including; stationary combustion, electricity, mobile combustion and refrigerants.

By leveraging innovative solutions and optimising energy use, we aim to accelerate meaningful reductions, ensuring alignment with both corporate and global climate goals. This steadfast focus underscores our role as a leader in driving impactful change across the industries and communities we serve.



Energy efficiency

Energy efficiency involves upgrading equipment, optimising operations, and using AI to improve network and office performance.



Renewable energy procurement

Renewable energy purchasing focuses on corporate power purchase agreements (PPAs) and international renewable energy certificates (I-RECs) to source cleaner electricity.



Refrigerant gases

Free cooling and gas replacement targets emissions from refrigerants and fire suppressants by adopting low global warming potential alternatives.



Renewable generation

On-site renewable generation, such as solar PV, provides a partial energy supply, with battery storage and diesel hybrid solutions for off-grid sites.



Fleet electrification

Fleet electrification replaces our current combustion vehicles with electric alternatives, though challenges remain in the supply of cleaner shipping fuel in e-marine, however, alternatives are being developed.



Carbon offset

Carbon offsetting will address any difficult to abate emissions. This will be achieved through credible offset projects that align with SBTi requirements.

Accelerating Scope 3 decarbonisation efforts

Guided by our comprehensive decarbonisation strategy, we are committed to achieving a 25% reduction in Scope 3 emissions by 2030, based on a 2022 baseline. This ambitious target underscores the importance of collaboration across our value chain and our dedication to sustainable growth.

To drive these reductions, we are embedding sustainability into our supply chain through our Responsible Procurement Strategy, Project Life. By integrating ESG principles into our Supplier Code of Ethical Conduct and Procurement Manual, we have refined processes and upskilled our Group Procurement team to address environmental risks. Supported by platforms like EcoVadis, we can assess ESG risks, collect GHG data from suppliers, and map emissions across our supply chain, which allows us to pinpoint emissions hotspots and support suppliers with their own decarbonisation efforts.

Additionally, we are working with key investee companies to assess the impact of mergers and acquisitions (M&A) on our emissions and aligning transition pathways with our decarbonisation objectives. Accurate data is at the core of these efforts, and in 2024, we refined our Scope 3 emissions reporting processes to enhance data quality and transparency. Ongoing investments in governance, GHG data management tools, and robust internal controls, will further support these goals. Where emissions cannot be reduced, we will offset any difficult to abate emissions through credible

offset projects that are aligning with SBTi requirements.

Proactively managing climate-related risks Governance

To ensure these risks are managed effectively, our findings are embedded within our corporate governance framework. The Sustainability Risk Framework undergoes annual review by the NRC, Sustainability Committee, and Group Risk Committee, ensuring robust oversight and alignment with our strategic objectives. This governance structure underscores our commitment to integrating sustainability into all aspects of our operations and decision-making. By proactively addressing climate transition risks, we are safeguarding our business operations and enhancing our position as a leader in sustainable innovation and resilience.

Risk management

The Group is committed to becoming a leading technology company. In 2024, we began assessing our climate-related risks and opportunities, viewing this as an integral component of our strategy to achieve this goal. To fully understand the potential impacts of climate change on e&S's business model, the Sustainability Committee initiated a detailed review of the key climate-related risks relevant to the business. This process involved mapping over 25 potential transition risks collated from peer benchmarks and industry reports. The prioritisation of the long list of transition risks was achieved

based on a framework considering risk criticality and assessment feasibility for scenario analysis. Using this risk assessment methodology, ten transition risks most relevant to our operations were identified from which three transition risks were prioritised for detailed quantification using scenario analysis frameworks.

The Group is assessing existing plans and mitigations for identified risks, determining further actions to meet our public commitments, and will integrate this analysis with our risk management approach through the relevant governance process in 2025.

Metrics and targets

To track our progress against our emissions reduction commitments, we monitor key performance metrics, with a primary focus on Scope 1 and 2 emissions to measure our decarbonisation efforts. Scope 3 emissions data collection is gradually improving as we deepen engagement with vendors and identify the products and services with the greatest impact. Our targets are outlined in our Climate Transition Plan (CTP), and as we review our progress, we will update our metrics and targets to align with emerging requirements.

→ Continues

Pillar 1 | Managing our environmental footprint

Climate action continued

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Future focus

As we continue to expand, the potential challenges of balancing rapid growth with environmental objectives will require careful management. However, advancements in energy efficiency and modernisation technologies present substantial opportunities to enhance operational performance, reduce costs, and further accelerate our sustainability efforts. To address the complexities associated with acquisitions, we are collaborating with the M&A team to integrate new businesses seamlessly into our CTP, ensuring alignment with our net zero trajectory.

In 2025, we plan to re-baseline our GHG emissions data from 2022 onwards to account for the Group's growing footprint, ensuring accurate tracking and alignment with our expansion. We will also introduce a GHG emissions data management tool to monitor progress against our targets across every market. For the first time, we will externally assure our GHG data, enhancing transparency and credibility in our reporting. Whilst we secured a B rating from the Carbon Disclosure Project for our climate commitments in 2024, we are aiming for an A- grade rating in 2025 with the publication of our CTP.

We will intensify efforts to reduce our carbon footprint through expanded sustainable practices. Stage 2 of Project Life, our Sustainable Procurement programme, will also be rolled out, further embedding sustainability into our supply chain

practices. We will also seek to further optimise energy consumption, increase the integration of renewable energy sources, and accelerate the transition to electric vehicles across our operations. By implementing these measures, we aim to achieve a balance between environmental responsibility and operational growth, supporting our broader sustainability goals while driving business performance.

Our long-term vision remains to achieve our net zero targets ahead of 2030 in our UAE operations (Scope 1 and 2). We will focus on maintaining momentum while leveraging emerging technologies to enable precise measurements, swift action, and sustainable growth. This commitment ensures our business expansion remains firmly aligned with environmental stewardship, reinforcing e&s position as a leader in sustainability-driven innovation.

Thought leadership: green shoots - a new model for renewables in the GCC

Working with GSMA Intelligence and as members of the Gulf Cooperative Council Sustainability Innovation Hub, we published a new report outlining the current availability of renewables in telecommunications with insights into the operational, technological and regulatory hurdles to enable operators to reach net zero by 2050. The report outlined how collective action is essential in all operators achieving their targets and greening the network infrastructure. While GSMA estimate the total industry carbon footprint at 0.3% of global emissions, renewable energy still constitutes only 20% of

Our performance	2022	2023	2024
Scope 1 GHG emissions (tCO ₂ e)	398,378	387,594**	380,406
Scope 2 GHG emissions (tCO ₂ e) - market based	1,519,824	1,462,151**	1,363,344
Scope 3 GHG emissions (tCO ₂ e)	1,836,100	1,993,689**	***
Total GHG emissions (tCO ₂ e)	3,754,302	3,843,434**	***
Scope 1 + Scope 2 GHG emissions (tCO ₂ e)	1,918,202	1,849,746**	1,743,750
Reduction of GHG emissions Scope 1 + 2 (tCO ₂ e)	n/a	68,456**	105,996
Total energy consumption within the organisation (MWh)	3,869,467	3,958,631**	4,076,386
Total renewable energy consumption (MWh)	85,276	123,623	272,284
Total non-renewable energy consumption (MWh)	3,784,191	3,835,008**	3,804,102
Total fuel consumption within the organisation from non-renewable sources (MWh)	1,129,903	1,283,239**	1,271,968
Total electricity consumption (MWh)	2,738,534	2,674,158**	2,803,033
Renewable electricity consumption (MWh)	85,276	123,623	272,284
Total energy consumed: percentage grid electricity (%)	69	64**	62
Total energy consumed: percentage renewable (%)	2	3	7

* This set of data covers our global operations, including operating companies for 2024, except for newly acquired PPF.

** Data restated due to updated emissions factors, and revision of previously-used estimates with established emissions data.

***Data unavailable at time of publication.

the average operators power usage. The report builds on recent activity by the hub's work in pioneering solutions to accelerate renewable energy solutions with a specific focus on AI power solutions. The hub is proving to be an effective forum for collaboration and testing, and developing new solutions.

Scope 1 GHG emissions (tCO₂e)

2024	380,406
2023	387,594
2022	398,378

Scope 2 GHG emissions (tCO₂e) - market based

2024	1,363,344
2023	1,462,151
2022	1,519,820

→ Continues

Pillar 1 | Managing our environmental footprint

Climate action continued

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Solar on exchange and mobile sites: Enhancing renewables adoption at e&

Harnessing the sun for a greener future

Our Solar on Exchange and Mobile Sites initiative represents a transformative step towards renewable energy adoption, integrating solar systems across rooftops, car parks, and ground-mounted locations. This milestone project underscores our commitment to reducing carbon emissions, improving environmental performance, and advancing global climate action. By generating renewable energy on-site, the initiative directly supports our goals to lower Scope 1 and Scope 2 emissions while reducing reliance on commercial power and diesel generators.

Overcoming barriers to renewable integration

This initiative presented significant opportunities to align with our ambition to achieve net zero emissions by 2030 while improving our ESG rankings. However, challenges arose, including regulatory compliance, site-specific technical constraints, and the complexity of integrating solar systems with existing infrastructure. These hurdles were effectively managed through collaboration with utility providers, site assessments, and tailored engineering solutions, ensuring seamless implementation.

Advancing solar energy systems

We partnered with highly qualified contractors and consultants, adhering to rigorous quality and safety standards, to design and implement on-grid and off-grid solar systems. Approved by utility authorities, these systems generate renewable energy on-site, minimising our environmental impact and maximising energy efficiency. This approach reflects our broader strategy to integrate sustainable energy solutions across our operations, fostering resilience and cost efficiency.

A cleaner energy landscape

The initiative is projected to deliver substantial environmental and financial benefits, including a carbon reduction of 2,490 tonnes annually, the generation of 1,878 MWh of renewable energy, and the elimination of 0.6 million litres of diesel usage each year. These efforts contribute to reduced energy costs and long-term savings for e& UAE while reinforcing our role as an environmental leader, empowering customers and communities to lower their carbon footprints.

“

Renewable energy is at the heart of our commitment to a greener future, reducing our carbon footprint while demonstrating leadership in sustainable business and operations practices in the region.”

Bakheet Alameri

Senior Vice President, Deployment & Field Operation



Pillar 1 | Managing our environmental footprint

Climate action continued

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Charge&go:

Transforming the EV charging network

A greener vision for mobility

Through our Charge&go initiative, we have undertaken a transformative project to establish an EV charging network, directly supporting our sustainability goals and the UAE's vision for a cleaner, greener environment. This initiative began with converting the Etisalat fleet from fuel-based to electric vehicles and has since expanded to cater to public and business sectors. With approximately 170 strategically located chargers installed across the UAE, we have made EV charging accessible and efficient, encouraging wider adoption of electric vehicles while contributing to a more sustainable future.

Accelerating EV adoption amid complexities

We identified an immense opportunity to advance the UAE government's ESG objectives and accelerate the shift to electric mobility. However, this endeavour came with challenges, including obtaining regulatory approvals in all emirates, engaging multiple stakeholders, and securing suitable locations for infrastructure deployment. Despite these complexities, we succeeded in building a robust EV charging ecosystem that aligns with the nation's goals and serves as a model for sustainable mobility.

Building a seamless EV charging ecosystem

To achieve this, we partnered with top EV manufacturers, charger providers, infrastructure contractors, and property developers to develop an end-to-end EV charging solution. With the collaboration of government and private property owners, we secured high-traffic locations for deploying chargers that serve both tenants and visitors. A landmark achievement was the launch of the UAE's first 360 kWh ultra-fast charger, which allows EV users to power their vehicles in a fraction of the time, underscoring our leadership in innovation and sustainability.

Powering a sustainable future

Charge&go has positioned us as the only EV charging infrastructure provider with a presence in every emirate. The initiative contributed to offsetting 1,760 tonnes of CO₂ emissions, displacing 304,000 litres of oil, and equating to the addition of 80,000 trees in 2024 alone. This enhances our brand's commitment to sustainability and innovation while also providing crucial support to businesses and consumers striving to meet their ESG goals. By empowering a cleaner mobility ecosystem, we have set a new standard in the UAE for environmentally responsible transportation.



At Charge&go we are committed to provide cleaner and greener energy to enable sustainable mobility in the UAE and beyond."

Muammar Al Rukhaimi
CEO, Etisalat Services Holding

Pillar 1 | Managing our environmental footprint

Climate action continued

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Weathering the storm

e&'s Effective flood response in the UAE

Business Continuity & Crisis Management: preparing for any eventuality

At e&, our Business Continuity & Crisis Management (BC&CM) team plays a critical role in establishment, implementation, and maintenance of the business continuity lifecycle in accordance with national, international standards and best practices (ISO 22301:2019, NCEMA 7000 and BCI Good Practice Guidelines Edition 7.0), which includes the identification and mitigation of risks that could disrupt operations, such as those posed by natural disasters. The team focuses on potential threats such as damage to infrastructure, employee safety challenges, supply chain disruptions, regulatory non-compliance, and service interruptions. Our proactive strategies and controls reinforce resilience, ensure operational continuity and safeguard our stakeholders.

e&'s BC&CM governance structure ensures robust safety and agility by integrating a comprehensive framework across all business units, verticals, subsidiaries, and international operating companies. Reporting to the Group COO, the team is empowered to consider Business Continuity Management System

(BCMS) practices as part of the day-to-day activities. The slogan followed by the BC&CM team is "Preparedness Today... Resilience Tomorrow", embracing a culture of preparedness and resilience.

The BC&CM team oversees the Business Continuity Management System (BCMS) lifecycle, ensuring seamless alignment across the Group. Each business unit is represented by a Business Continuity Champion, whose roles and responsibilities are defined in the e& Directive for Crisis Management Team (CMT).

Our BCMS, undergoes an annual review to maintain compliance and relevance, is underpinned by the e& Business Continuity Policy. [The full policy can be seen here.](#)

We manage business continuity risks with an approach that ensures resilience and operational stability. We conduct regular risk assessments to identify potential impacts and develop tailored continuity. To minimise vulnerabilities, we invest in robust infrastructure and backup systems for critical assets and data, in addition to maintaining diversified supplier relationships. Reliable communication channels facilitate effective coordination and timely stakeholder updates. To further strengthen our preparedness, we secure adequate insurance coverage and regularly conduct training sessions and

simulation drills, equipping our teams for efficient response and recovery in any scenario.

An unprecedented challenge: record rainfall

In April 2024, the UAE faced an extraordinary challenge with the heaviest rainfall in 75 years, leading to widespread flooding across the nation. These rainfalls are equivalent to London's rainfall over three months. This unprecedented weather event disrupted infrastructure, strained services, and impacted communities, posing a significant test to e&'s resilience and preparedness. Our mission to ensure uninterrupted connectivity and support became a cornerstone of our response.

Swift action: the initial response

We activated our Crisis Management team to manage operations round the clock. Our technical teams were mobilised to safeguard critical infrastructure, deploying water pumps, tankers, special purpose trucks, sandbags, and other protective measures to minimise damage. Network monitoring systems provided real-time insights, enabling us to anticipate and address potential disruptions. Employee safety was prioritised through remote work arrangements, ensuring that critical operations continued seamlessly while safeguarding

our workforce. VSAT-enabled Cell on Wheels (CoW) were deployed in regions experiencing service interruptions.

Seamless collaboration: communication and coordination

Effective communication and coordination are central to e&'s Business Continuity and Crisis Management framework. Internally, regular training sessions and simulation exercises involving all business units and Business Continuity Champions ensure readiness, improve collaboration, and refine continuity plans. This proactive approach, guided by the BC policy and governance structure, fosters seamless internal alignment.

Externally, we maintain strong ties with regulatory bodies such as TDRA and NCEMA to ensure resource deployment and compliance with national guidelines. Transparent communication with stakeholders builds trust, while mobile units and specialised vehicles ensure swift action in affected areas.

Navigating forward: recovery and learning

Our business continuity approach kept critical services operational during the historic event. Minor disruptions were swiftly addressed, and recovery teams restored full

operational capacity. The event provided invaluable lessons, highlighting opportunities for flood-resistant infrastructure, expanding fleet capabilities, and enhancing coordination with government agencies. Regular drills and advanced technologies will continue to strengthen our preparedness, ensuring we remain agile and resilient in navigating future challenges.



Our swift response to the unprecedented rains highlights e&'s commitment to keeping people connected, ensuring uninterrupted connectivity and support for all our stakeholders. By turning challenges to opportunities, we continue to set new benchmarks for resilience, crisis management and sustainable growth."

Abdalla Rashid Alsaadi
Senior Vice President – e&
Group Business Continuity &
Crisis Management

Pillar 1 | Managing our environmental footprint

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2 Waste management and circularity



This year, we took bold steps to strengthen waste management and circularity across our operations. Through initiatives such as source segregation for efficient recycling and our asset second-life programme, we enhanced resource optimisation and waste diversion efforts. With a strong governance framework, innovative approaches, and a culture of responsibility, we continue to drive meaningful progress towards a more sustainable and circular future.”

Obaid Bokisha
Group Chief Operations Officer

Definition of material matter:

The way in which e& manages its waste streams: securely disposing of hazardous waste, correctly managing e-waste, overall reducing waste and increasing recycling while striving towards more circularity: reusing, recycling and refurbishing customer products.

Why it is material to e&:

Within our industry, operational waste and e-waste have a significant environmental impact, which we must minimise. Customer demand for more sustainable products and services is growing, and we need to address the end-of-life impact of the products we sell.

Type of impact:

By addressing the challenges posed by e-waste and the proper disposal of the products we sell collaboratively across our value chain, we will reduce our negative environmental impact and improve e&'s reputation.

Value chain impact:

- Upstream
- Operations
- Downstream

Key stakeholders:

- Customers
- Employees
- Community
- Local and national authorities

Policies:

- [e& Group Environmental Management Policy](#)

Our management approach

In 2024, e& maintained a robust governance framework for waste management, guided by our Environmental Management Policy and supported by the Environmental Management System (EMS). Health, Safety, and Environment (HSE) and administration teams, both functioning under e& Operations, foster collaboration across the organisation, as we strengthen partnerships and awareness initiatives to further embed sustainability within our operations.

Progress in 2024

e& takes a multi-pronged approach to manage waste effectively, enhancing operational efficiency and sustainability while mitigating risks associated with improper disposal. By transitioning to digital solutions, the Company reduced paper and operational waste. Our Managed Printing Solutions (MPS) monitors monthly and annual paper consumption, and in the immediate future, we are looking into assigning a print quota and monitoring for individual usage. Currently the colour print options are limited to a very minimal number of users to reduce our footprint.

In addition, segregation protocols and dedicated waste bins were established for hazardous, recyclable, and general waste, ensuring responsible handling and disposal. We initiated a corporate-

→ Continues

Pillar 1 | Managing our environmental footprint

Waste management and circularity continued

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Enhancing circularity

As part of our Climate Transition Plan, e& is advancing an ambitious goal to enhance circularity across our operations, aiming to reduce raw material use, extend product lifecycles and minimise waste by 2030. Our approach to circularity focuses on three key phases: inflows, use phase and outflows.

Inflows:

To optimise material procurement, e& is implementing “Project Life” to establish sustainable procurement guidelines. We will conduct annual supplier programmes and audits to verify compliance with circularity indicators for our top 30 suppliers, targeting completion by 2027.

Use phase:

e& will prioritise extending product lifespans by providing repair and recycling services to all customers by 2027. We are working to reuse or repurpose 75% of our network equipment and offer refurbished devices to customers by 2028.

Outflows:

In addressing waste management, e& aims to divert 50% of waste from landfills by 2028, introduce KPIs for local operations on reuse and recycling by 2026, and achieve a 20% reduction in e-waste by 2028.

We launched the Hayyak e-Marketplace to support our Second Life programme for corporate assets. This platform enables interested employees to participate in the reuse of high-quality pre-owned corporate assets, promoting circularity, reducing waste, and maximising resource efficiency.

wide “Segregate at Source” waste disposal programme to enhance recycling efficiency. This initiative marks significant progress in waste management by improving resource recovery and supporting sustainable disposal practices across our operations. With our focused recycling efforts for paper waste alone, we recycled 97.22 tons of paper and cardboard, directly saving 1,652 trees, 97,220 kg of CO₂, 2.58 million litres of water, 292 m³ of landfill space, and 398,602 kWh of energy – further reinforcing our commitment to sustainability and the circular economy¹. Partnerships with certified recycling vendors allowed materials such as plastics, metals, and e-waste to be recycled effectively, while compliance with

regulatory standards ensured proper management of hazardous waste.

Through the “No More Bottles” initiative, we eliminated the use of over 23,659 plastic bottles, reducing waste and promoting sustainability. This initiative was implemented while ensuring optimal drinking water quality, verified through approved laboratory testing, reinforcing our commitment to environmental responsibility and resource conservation.

We achieved LEED Gold certification from the US Green Building Council for our T&A Building in Abu Dhabi and Al Kifaf building in Dubai. This certification signifies our commitment and efforts to sustainable building practices, energy efficiency, and environmental stewardship across

our operations. Another notable progress is the expansion of the scope of our Environmental Management System (EMS) under ISO 14001 to cover all high-rise buildings (HRBs) across the UAE. This expansion reinforces our commitment to environmental management, ensuring sustainable practices and compliance across our operations.

Training and awareness

e& launched initiatives covering digitalisation, material substitution, and supplier collaboration to minimise hazardous materials. Employee training programmes focused on preventing waste generation, while customer-facing initiatives such as device recycling and e-waste return programmes

Our performance	2021	2022	2023	2024
Total waste generated (tons)	326.58	834.46	1126.65	1369.13
Hazardous waste generated (tons)	115	95	110	191.5
Non-hazardous waste generated (tons)	211.58	739.46	1016.65	1158.73
Non-hazardous waste recycled (tons)	70.96	283	278.15	249.77
E-waste generated (tons)*	26.5	17.5	34	18.9
Number of facilities covered by ISO 14001 certification (high-rise buildings)	5	5	5	10

*Calculated based on internal estimates

offered incentives for responsible disposal. Awareness campaigns further educated customers on the importance of recycling, creating a shared commitment to sustainability.

Impact and continuous improvement

e&'s waste management efforts in 2024 resulted in efficient recycling. Environmental protection measures, including workshops and campaigns, engaged employees and partners, fostering a culture of sustainability. Regular performance tracking and audits – including monthly records for waste audits, yearly training plans for EMS and the entire HSE team, with specific training for waste management – ensured continuous improvement.

Non-hazardous waste recycled

2024	249.77
2023	278.15
2022	283.0
2021	70.96

→ Continues

¹ Data presented in equivalent terms provided by our recycling partners

Pillar 1 | Managing our environmental footprint

Waste management and circularity continued

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Protecting biodiversity

As outlined in our Climate Transition Plan, e& is committed to achieving a minimum of no net loss of biodiversity across our direct operations by 2030, using 2025 as a baseline, while ensuring compliance with existing and emerging nature-related regulations in relevant geographies. Recognising the five primary drivers of biodiversity loss – land and sea use change, resource exploitation, climate change, pollution, and invasive species – e& addresses these pressures through a structured approach.

Future focus

Looking ahead to 2025, we will focus on raising awareness about recycling and fostering collaboration among our employees and partners to ensure the success of our waste management initiatives. Our priority is to educate and engage our teams, encouraging them to fully embrace and support our impactful recycling measures. By embedding these practices into our daily operations, we aim to create a collective effort where environmental responsibility becomes a fundamental aspect of our workplace culture.

Looking further to 2030, we envision achieving a zero-waste environment by leveraging innovative recycling technologies and continuously improving our waste management strategies. Our long-term goal is to cultivate a workplace where sustainability becomes second nature to everyone at e&, reflecting our shared commitment to environmental stewardship.

Reloop at e&:

Driving circularity in the workplace

Building a greener workplace

In 2024, e& introduced a workplace recycling initiative as part of our broader commitment to circularity and sustainable business practices. Across all HRB floors, segregated waste bins for paper, plastic, metal, and general waste, along with dedicated e-waste collection points, were installed to reduce landfill contributions. Partnering with Reloop, e& aimed to foster a culture of environmental responsibility among employees while improving waste management practices.

Turning resistance into opportunity

While the initiative promised to enhance circularity, staff resistance to change emerged as a significant hurdle. Shifting workplace habits required both strategic communication and persistent effort to inspire participation. This challenge became an opportunity to educate and engage employees, reinforcing the importance of sustainable practices in everyday work.

A partnership for progress

Collaborating with Reloop, e& implemented a seamless recycling system supported by staff awareness sessions and clear signage. These measures helped overcome initial reluctance, aligning workplace practices with e&'s circularity goals. By integrating recycling into the workflow, the initiative created a practical and scalable solution for waste reduction.

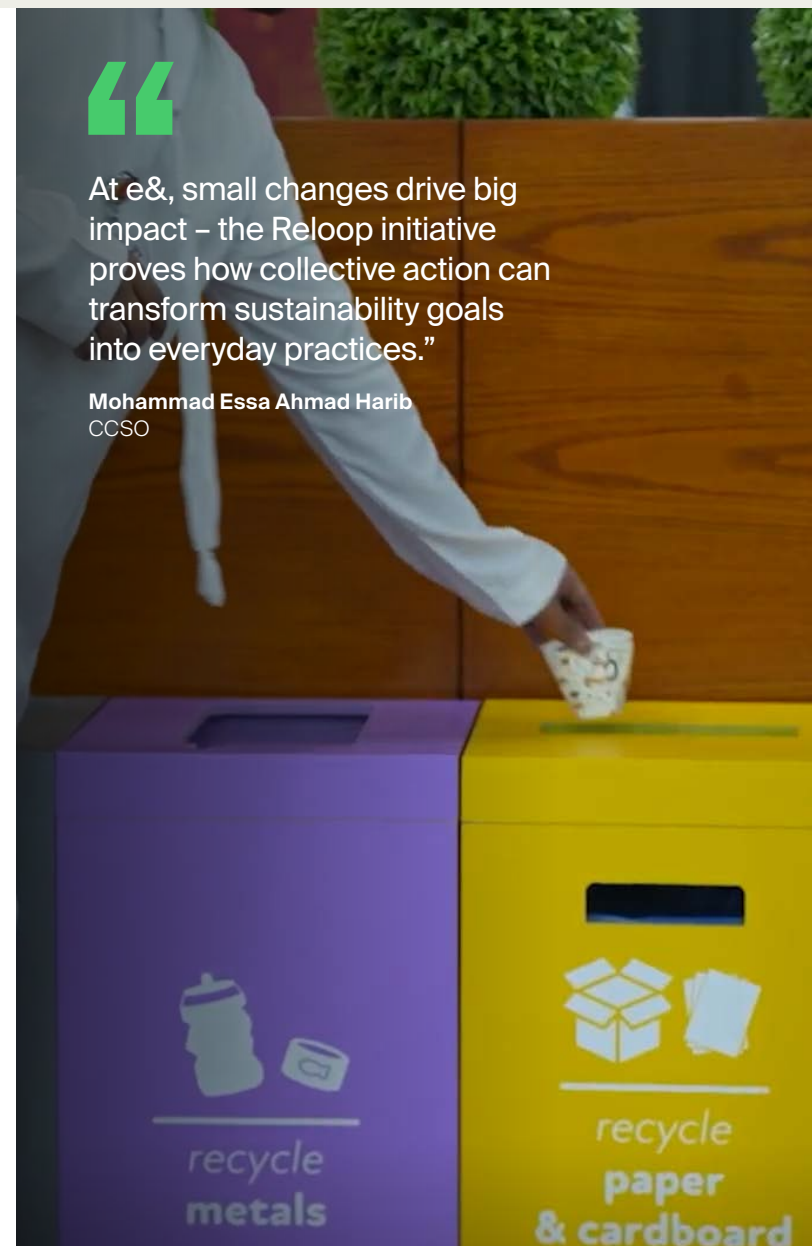
Sustainability gains in action

The initiative succeeded in increasing recycling rates while catalysing meaningful conversations around sustainability among employees. It transformed e&'s workplace into an eco-conscious environment, demonstrating our leadership in sustainable operations and creating long-term environmental value.



At e&, small changes drive big impact – the Reloop initiative proves how collective action can transform sustainability goals into everyday practices.”

Mohammad Essa Ahmad Harib
CCSO



Pillar 1 | Managing our environmental footprint

Waste management and circularity continued

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Yettel Serbia:

Driving sustainability through device recycling

A commitment to green innovation

Yettel Serbia, part of e& PPF Telecom, celebrated three years of its electronic device recycling programme this year, positioning itself as a leader in sustainable practices in the Serbian telecommunications market. Through initiatives like “The more you recycle, the bigger discount you get”, the programme incentivised customers to recycle their old devices while offering discounts on new ones. This effort was aligned with Yettel’s broader ESG objectives, combining environmental responsibility with innovative customer engagement.

Transforming challenges into opportunities

The challenge lay in designing ESG-aligned initiatives that seamlessly integrated into Yettel’s commercial strategy. Navigating local recycling regulations and securing partnerships with reliable, licensed operators added complexity. However, these challenges presented an opportunity to strengthen Yettel’s market differentiation and enhance its brand perception as an environmentally responsible leader.

Pioneering recycling solutions

Yettel partnered with local recycling operators to implement its device recycling and Eco Bonus programmes. These collaborations ensured proper collection and recycling of e-waste, paper, and plastics. Additionally, the company introduced paperless retail transactions and e-billing to further reduce environmental impact. The recycling campaigns actively involved customers, encouraging personal participation in Yettel’s green agenda.

Delivering tangible results

In 2024, Yettel recycled 95.4 tonnes of electronic devices and set ambitious targets to recycle one million devices by 2025. It also recycled over 1,481 tonnes of paper and plastics through the Eco Bonus initiative and reduced paper waste by adding nearly 170,000 new e-billing users. With 90% of retail transactions now paperless, Yettel demonstrated measurable environmental impact while engaging customers in its sustainability journey.



We believe the best way to drive impact and raise awareness of our green-commercial agenda is by engaging our customers personally. Recycling campaigns, Eco Bonus initiative, and our 100% green network have been key. By 2025, we aim to recycle one million devices, solidifying Yettel as Serbia’s top destination for recycling and purchasing devices.”

Dejan Marković
Consumer Marketing Manager



Pillar 1 | Managing our environmental footprint

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3 Water usage



Water is a precious resource, and at e&, we are committed to using it responsibly. Through targeted conservation initiatives, infrastructure optimisation, and staff engagement, we are enhancing efficiency and promoting sustainable water management. Our efforts ensure that we minimise our environmental impact while contributing to the long-term sustainability of the communities we serve.”

Obaid Bokisha
Group Chief Operations Officer

Definition of material matter:

The way in which e& manages its water use across its operations.

Why it is material to e&:

The telecommunications sector may not be a water intensive industry, but e& operates in water scarce regions. Water management and conservation is material to us and the communities in which we work.

Type of impact:

Lack of efficient water management processes could lead to water waste and increased water costs in water scarce regions.

Value chain impact:

- Operations

Key stakeholders:

- Customers
- Employees
- Community

Policies:

- [e& Group Environmental Management Policy](#)

Our management approach

Efficient water management is a key pillar of our commitment to sustainable operations. At e&, we implement a comprehensive strategy to optimise water use across our facilities. Municipal networks remain our primary water source, complemented by measures such as low-flow fixtures, water reuse initiative and advanced automation and sensor technologies to monitor and reduce consumption.

In line with our sustainability objectives, 10 of our UAE facilities have achieved ISO 14001 certification, underscoring our adherence to internationally recognised environmental management standards.

Water management is governed by our Group-wide Environmental Management Policy and supported by an Environmental Management System (EMS) designed to ensure consistent and effective practices. Our Health, Safety, and Environment (HSE) and Administration teams, both functioning under e& Operations, play a pivotal role in addressing all corporate water-related issues.

Progress in 2024

During 2024, we made considerable progress in water management by employing a comprehensive approach that included low-flow fixtures and automated sensors in high-rise buildings across our UAE operations.

[→ Continues](#)

Pillar 1 | Managing our environmental footprint

Water usage continued

Our performance	2021	2022	2023	2024
Total water consumption (cubic meters)	309,377.00	306,044.12*	309,805.90*	289,329.43

*Data restated due to improved data availability

Regular audits and risk assessments through our Environmental Management System helped us identify inefficiencies and improve water usage patterns, enabling us to meet and exceed our 0.5% reduction target in water usage annual target (6.60% reduction in 2024). Additionally, we prioritised employee engagement through educational programmes that encouraged responsible water use and swift reporting of leaks or issues.

Our Ras Al Khaimah high-rise building (HRB) office tower operates an in-house Sewerage Treatment Plant (STP) that treats wastewater onsite, discharging only treated water into the drainage network. A substantial portion of the treated water is reused for landscaping irrigation, supporting our commitment to water conservation and sustainable resource management.

e& was honoured with the Water Conservation Initiatives - Gold Award (GESGA 2024) in recognition of our efforts to enhance water efficiency and sustainability across our UAE operations. This award highlights the exceptional contributions of our Administration and Property Management department's efforts in water conservation and reflects our commitment to responsible water management and continuous improvement.

While challenges such as high-water consumption and difficulty in tracking leaks required ongoing attention, our proactive measures laid the foundation for continued improvement in water conservation.

Future focus

In 2025, we will focus on the goal of obtaining LEED Certification for additional buildings as part of our ongoing water conservation efforts. This goal reflects our commitment to optimising water use and aligning our operations with the highest sustainability standards.

Looking ahead to 2030 and beyond, we aspire to significantly reduce water waste by implementing advanced water recovery and reuse systems and continually improving our practices. As part of our Climate Transition Plan, we are committed to reducing absolute water withdrawals for direct operations in line with maximum allowable basin-wide levels. We are committed to a no net loss approach by 2030 against a 2025 baseline. In 2025, we plan to assess our land and water footprint to develop targets and policies with SBTN verification in mind. Our ultimate goal is to achieve zero water waste across all our facilities, reinforcing our commitment to responsible and sustainable water management.



Pillar 2 | People and society

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4 Diversity, equity and inclusion



At e&, embracing diversity, equity, and inclusion (DEI) as the cornerstone of our innovation is our blueprint for growth and progress. We are embedding equity and inclusion into the fabric of our business, empowering voices that challenge convention and drive innovation. In championing accessibility, equality, and youth engagement, we are creating a workforce that mirrors the boldness of our ambitions and the diversity of the world we live in and the communities we serve.”

Ali Al Mansoori
Group Chief People Officer

Definition of material matter:

For e&, diversity, equity and inclusion means recognising diversity amongst our workforce and broader stakeholders, treating people fairly, considering their unique circumstances and embracing a culture in which everyone feels included and heard.

Why it is material to e&:

It is our duty to respect and recognise the differences amongst our people and provide for a fair and inclusive workplace, free of discrimination.

A diverse, equitable and inclusive workplace is essential for fostering innovation, attracting new talent, reflecting our customer base and ultimately enhancing e&'s profitability.

Type of impact:

Diverse perspectives present an opportunity for innovation and growth.

However, failing to address diversity challenges poses a risk to our culture, overall performance and attractiveness to potential talent.

Value chain impact:

- Upstream
- Operations
- Downstream

Key stakeholders:

- Customers
- Employees
- Business partners
- Shareholders
- Community
- Local and national authorities

Targets

- Achieve a workforce gender diversity of 30% by 2030 in our UAE operations
- Increase representation of people with determination to 3% by 2030 in our UAE operations
- Increase youth representation to 15% by 2030 in our UAE operations

Our management approach

At e&, we believe diversity is our strength and aim to impact lasting change through our actions. We strive to build a company that represents a variety of backgrounds, perspectives, and abilities at all levels. Embedded within our HR framework, DEI permeates all aspects of our organisation. Our Code of Conduct is the central policy document detailing our core behavioural values and expectations, including our commitment to diversity, equity, and inclusion. As an equal opportunities employer, we uphold a strict no-tolerance policy against discrimination, bullying, and harassment.

Our DEI efforts focus on three core areas: Gender Diversity, People of Determination, and Youth. Each initiative is guided by our DEI team, ensuring strategic oversight and alignment with e&'s long-term goals. Through these targeted efforts, we are building an inclusive culture that empowers our people, reflects our values, and drives meaningful change across the organisation.

We actively collaborate with our operating companies (OpCos) to share best practices, enhance learning, and report progress transparently at the OpCo level, fostering collaboration and accountability.

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Pillar 2 | People and society

Diversity, equity and inclusion continued

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By working with employee groups across seniority levels and areas of the business, we connect with our employees to gather views, shape and implement e&'s DEI agenda, defining what it means to embrace diversity and foster inclusive environments across our operations. Our practices and policies are regularly updated to reflect our commitment. Support groups like the “New Mothers Network” and “New Fathers Network” have emerged as a result of this grass roots approach, offering tailored support to each employee demographic. This is strengthened by partnering with inclusion-focused organisations and networks, exchanging knowledge, collaborating and benchmarking against external best practices.

This year, we expanded the scope and governance of our e& Youth Council, which amplifies the voices of young employees. The council opened up to our international OpCos in 2024 - Afghanistan has nominated a representative and other OpCos are set to follow in 2025. This inclusive platform drives innovation and enriches our collective approach to DEI, as a living example of how e& applies our “Unite as One” core value.

We are committed to promoting the inclusion and equity of People of Determination, by encouraging equal opportunities and eliminating workplace discrimination based on disability. We actively implement measures to create accessible environments and inclusive systems that empower individuals of all abilities to thrive.

Progress in 2024

Gender diversity

Our commitment to gender diversity creates meaningful opportunities for underrepresented groups and fosters an inclusive workplace that promotes equal opportunities and career growth. Through targeted initiatives, we are empowering women across all levels of the organisation and impacting society by championing inclusivity.

We launched the “She Leads” programme in partnership with Nokia and UN Women, focusing on developing leadership skills for middle management females. A total of 22 female employees completed the first cohort of the She Leads programme in 2024. The programme aims to develop leadership skills, builds resilience, and encourages women to push boundaries within the organisation. Focused on long-term leadership growth, the programme provided valuable insights into individual leadership styles, empowering participants to navigate challenges with confidence. With a 96% average satisfaction rate, the programme successfully fostered a supportive and transformative learning experience for women leaders. For more information on our targeted development programmes, please see [page 30](#).

In celebration of Emirati Women's Day, our “She&” campaign showcased the strength and wisdom of Emirati women at e& through inspiring interviews and highlighted the contributions of outstanding female employees. Activities included a visit to Bait Al Banat Museum, where employees gained

valuable insights into the rich history of Emirati women's contributions.

Additionally, we introduced initiatives to support working parents, including a workshop titled “How to Survive the Summer”, offering practical advice on activities within the UAE and abroad, and hosted our first e& Mothers Gathering to collaboratively plan for future enhancements tailored to their needs. These programmes reflect our dedication to cultivating a workplace that values and supports diversity, inclusion, and the advancement of women.

By actively improving our recruitment processes and tools, partnering with diverse talent networks, and setting measurable goals to ensure balanced representation, we are seeing improvements in our gender diversity year on year.

People of determination

Fostering an inclusive environment for People of Determination (PoD) is a core priority at e&, reflecting our commitment to creating workplaces where everyone feels valued and empowered. By providing opportunities for employment, we enable financial independence, contribute to long-term economic growth, and drive innovation through the strength of diverse teams.

This year, we completed comprehensive accessibility assessments for three offices and two retail stores, focusing on physical and digital accessibility. These evaluations ensure upcoming renovations meet inclusive standards, benefiting both employees and customers. Additionally, we conducted a

Our performance	2021	2022	2023	2024
Proportion of women in our workforce (FTE, %)	24.2	24.6	25.8	26.2
Proportion of women in management (FTE, %)	13.5	13.8	15.5	15.6
Proportion of women in our top management (– SVP and above) (FTE %)	8	6	4	4
Proportion of women on our Board of Directors (%)	9.1	9.1	9.1	9.1
Gender pay ratio (men to women FTE)	1:0.68	1:0.72	1:0.71	1:0.78
Proportion of employees by age:<30/30-50/>50 years old (%)	8/80/12	8/75/17	7/74/18	9/75/16
Proportion of Gen Z employees (employees born 1996-2012) (FTE, %)	2.6	4.6	5.6	7.5
Number of nationalities (FTE)	70	71	74	70
Proportion of local UAE employees (FTE, %)	51.2	51.5	52.5	54.3

technical workshop for our Talent Acquisition team, equipping them with best practices for disability-inclusive hiring.

We partnered with The Butterfly's Inclusive Employment Ecosystem (IEE), a hub uniting public and private

sectors to promote inclusion for PoD. Through this collaboration, e& engages in monthly workshops, receives access to global best practices, self-assessment tools, and tailored guidance to enhance disability inclusion in our practices and policies.



e& participation in the Inclusive annual Disability Inclusion Summit and Career Fair

Pillar 2 | People and society

Diversity, equity and inclusion continued

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Our efforts extended to awareness-building initiatives, including campaigns and collaborative webinars through our DEI calendar. Highlights included our participation as the gold sponsor for ImInclusive's Disability Inclusion Summit and Career Fair, where we reinforced our commitment to empowering People of Determination and supporting the UAE's vision of inclusivity through innovative technology. Through our relationships with key partners that focus on diversity and inclusion, we are able to identify and connect with POD talent. Our recruitment processes ensure that we are consciously building a diverse and balanced candidate pipeline, identifying the right talent for the role irrespective of their ability, background or gender.

To deepen understanding and promote inclusion, we organised activities like an accessibility scavenger hunt on International Day of Persons with Disabilities and celebrated Autism Acceptance Month by educating employees on autism-friendly actions. Our partnership with ImInclusive brought valuable sessions, such as "Tips and Tools for Working Parents". Additionally, Youth Council members, trained in collaboration with the People of Determination Welfare and Rehabilitation Department, successfully delivered workshops further embedding inclusion into our organisational culture.

Youth

At e&, empowering youth is integral to our vision of fostering innovation, inclusivity, and sustainable growth. By providing young talent with meaningful opportunities, platforms, and partnerships, we aim to shape the next generation of leaders and contribute to the UAE's development goals.

This year, we completely revamped our internship programme, opening doors to over 200 students from diverse educational levels and backgrounds, including children and family members of our employees. The relaunch reflects our commitment to equipping youth with practical skills and exposure to the corporate world. We also launched the second cycle of our Youth Council, expanding it to include representatives from OpCos, forming a Global Youth Council. This council provides young employees from across regions a platform to influence global decisions, share innovative ideas, and foster cross-cultural collaboration, ultimately driving inclusivity and sustainable growth.

Collaborating with the Federal Youth Authority (FYA), we signed an MoU to amplify youth-focused initiatives beyond e&. Announced at GITEX GLOBAL, this partnership aligns with the National Youth Agenda 2031 and focuses on leadership, innovation, and skills development. Through this collaboration, we united public and private sectors to champion youth empowerment, supporting meaningful contributions to the UAE's progress.

We celebrated youth in various ways, including hosting Emirati students from the Emirates Global Youth Council in the UK at our Dubai headquarters for an Innovation Centre tour and discussions on technology and youth-focused topics. Initiatives like the AI Graduate Programme saw collaboration with the Artificial Intelligence, Digital Economy, and Remote Work Applications office to explore AI-driven innovations. Additionally, our Youth Podcast tackled themes of international opportunities and youth philanthropy, amplifying voices and ideas that inspire progress.

Internship programme

200
students

Recognition for our efforts

Our commitment to DEI has earned significant accolades, underscoring our dedication to creating an inclusive and welcoming environment. We were honoured with the Inclusive Place Badge and accreditation from The Butterfly, recognising our efforts to foster inclusivity across all aspects of our organisation.

Additionally, we received the Community Torchbearer Award 2024 from ImInclusive and the Ministry of Community Development, celebrating our leadership in advancing community inclusion. For the second consecutive year, we were proud recipients of The Butterfly Award for the Inclusive Employment Ecosystem, a testament to our journey towards greater inclusion for People of Determination.

Future focus

We are committed to developing and implementing a robust framework for DEI, encompassing gender diversity, People of Determination, and youth. This initiative will align all stakeholders with inclusive strategies, fostering a workplace culture that empowers and values every individual.

Our gender diversity goals include launching a C-level executive mentorship programme for diverse HiPo talent, revamping the e& She Leads programme to run future cohorts, and introducing a networking initiative for women. To further support working parents, we are committed to continue making strategic changes to policies and the physical working environment, as well as promote the organisational awareness, to ensure a more inclusive and supportive workplace.



e& Youth Council
members in the UAE

Pillar 2 | People and society

Diversity, equity and inclusion continued

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We plan to support new mothers in our organisation by training managers to ensure a positive experience and smooth integration back to work after their maternity leave. We will continue to build partnerships with leading networking groups and organisations to give our female employees opportunities to connect and exchange knowledge with other female leaders.

For People of Determination, we will embed inclusion principles into our refreshed Code of Conduct and introduce customised sign language training for retail staff to ensure accessible and inclusive customer experiences. We plan to launch a pilot of the e& People of Determination internship programme in retail stores across three locations during the summer, with the aim of extending this into a regular programme across the Emirates. We are working with academic institutions and our inclusivity partners to offer both workshops and work experience opportunities for People of Determination students, empowering our next generation of leaders and exposing students to AI technologies. Additionally, we will implement disability training for new employees and inclusive leadership training for managers to further enhance an environment where everyone thrives. We will continue to upgrade our facilities, including offices and stores, using the findings of our accessibility report to ensure they are inclusive to all employees and customers.

To empower youth, we will host transformative experiences such as a Youth Townhall and Retreat, Youth Circles, and Youth World Skills Day. Our Global Youth Council will continue to create opportunities for young talents to contribute innovative ideas and gain representation in key company decisions, solidifying their role as drivers of cultural transformation.

Looking beyond 2025, we aim to achieve measurable outcomes, including 30% gender diversity, 3% People of Determination representation, and 15% youth representation within our UAE operations. We will publicly report progress towards gender equality and ensure our workplace integrates Gen Z through representation at key events and a culture that enables them to thrive. These efforts will drive economic and social well-being, positioning e& as a leader in inclusivity and empowerment.

2030 targets

30%
gender diversity

3%
People of Determination
representation

15%
youth representation

Empowering change: PTCL's gender equity drive

Creating a foundation of inclusion

PTCL Group reaffirmed its commitment to diversity, equity, and inclusion with the launch of enhanced gender-equity policies. These efforts aimed to establish a supportive workplace culture that values all employees to drive meaningful social impact. The initiatives reflect PTCL's dedication to fostering a balanced and progressive environment.

Pioneering policies for progress

To address workplace disparities, we implemented five pivotal measures. Maternity leave was extended to six months, with paternity leave increased to 30 days, ensuring a supportive environment for new parents. Flexible work schedules and an expanded work-from-home policy promote work-life balance and employee satisfaction. The "Green Friday" initiative advances sustainability by reducing traffic and environmental impact, while company-managed transport provides female employees with safe and cost-effective commuting options.

Building a better workplace

Our gender-equity initiatives are designed to enhance employee engagement, retention, and productivity. By addressing gender disparities and fostering inclusion, PTCL strengthened its reputation as a socially responsible and forward-thinking organisation. These measures contribute to operational efficiency, cost savings, and environmental sustainability, benefiting both employees and the broader community.

Driving impact beyond compliance

The introduction of these policies improved employee experience by advancing workplace equity and sustainability to position PTCL as a leader in corporate responsibility and innovation.



Our policies focused on gender equality are a reflection of our commitment to building a diverse and inclusive workplace."

Muhammad Taimoor Khan

Group Vice President & Head of Sustainability & Corporate HSE, PTCL & Ufone

Pillar 2 | People and society

Diversity, equity and inclusion continued

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Empowering change:

Empowering inclusion at e& Egypt

Championing diversity and belonging

At e& Egypt, we prioritise creating an inclusive workplace where every individual feels valued and supported. DEI is central to our strategy, driving innovation, collaboration, and sustainable growth. By embedding equity and diversity across all levels, we contribute meaningfully to the Egyptian community and economy while fostering a culture of belonging.

Innovative actions for change

We have revolutionised workplace inclusion through groundbreaking initiatives. Gender inclusive hiring policies and extended parental leave have empowered women, supported by campaigns showcasing female leadership and resilience. Youth-focused programmes, including partnerships with top universities, are cultivating the next generation of talent. For People of Determination, partnerships with Helm and SEED Academy have provided critical training and employment opportunities, while accessibility workshops and a referral programme have strengthened workplace inclusion and community engagement.

Driving impact and transformation

Our initiatives have yielded transformative results. Female representation rose to 23%, youth under 30 make up 46% of our workforce, and People of Determination representation increased by 45%, reaching 7%. Engagement scores reflect industry-leading inclusive leadership, and psychological safety campaigns achieved 92% satisfaction. With 500 People of Determination graduates from SEED Academy ready to join the workforce, our efforts are shaping a more inclusive and equitable future.

Such achievements were recognised and awarded through the following esteemed certifications and awards including:

- Top Employer Egypt and Africa 2025
- Best Places to work Certified, securing the esteemed # 1 position in Egypt and Middle East and 3rd position on World's Best Places to Work Rank
- Future Workplace Best DEI Strategy



Inclusion isn't just about preparing individuals for the workplace, it's about creating confidence, fostering happiness and learning to grow together as better people and leaders."

Dalia ElGezery

Chief HR and Administration Officer, e& Egypt

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5 Talent attraction, retention and development



Our people are the heart and soul of e&'s transformation journey, and the strength of our organisation lies not just in attracting the best talent but in challenging them to think bigger, act bolder, and create a lasting impact because talent isn't just recruited; it's ignited. By investing in our people's growth, equipping them with the tools to lead us into the future and the freedom to dream, and creating an environment where talent is nurtured, valued, and inspired, we ensure our organisation remains agile and prepared to navigate the complexities of change and transformation."

Ali Al Mansoori
Group Chief People Officer

Definition of material matter:

e& recognises the important role human capital plays in shaping our success, aligning with the current trend of prioritising employee well-being and growth. A diverse and skilled workforce is key to fostering innovation and inclusivity.

Why it is material to e&:

Effective talent management is crucial for e& as it directly impacts operational efficiency, innovation and customer satisfaction. It is material since our success hinges on the capabilities, health and growth of our workforce. We have the duty to take care of our employees by remunerating them fairly, assisting their development and safeguarding well-being, in compliance with applicable laws.

Type of impact:

Positive impacts include enhanced innovation, improved employee satisfaction and strengthened organisational resilience. Negative impacts may arise from talent shortages, skill gaps or unhealthy turnover rates.

Value chain impact:

- Operations

Key stakeholders:

- Employees
- Community
- Local and national authorities

Policies:

- e& HR Manual

Our management approach

At e&, we are dedicated to fostering a workplace that attracts, retains, and develops top talent through transparent and forward-thinking talent management practices. Our approach is built on a strategic framework that integrates competitive compensation, professional development opportunities, and an inclusive work environment. By aligning recruitment strategies with our values and objectives, we ensure a seamless fit for new hires who are ready to contribute to our transformative goals. Once onboard, employees are supported through a robust ecosystem of engagement initiatives, rewards, and recognition programmes that nurture their growth and motivation.

Our learning and development efforts revolve around e&'s transformation from a Telco to a global techco focusing on programmes that address competencies and skills of the future. Each programme is tailored to the relevant learning group whether new joiners, subject matter experts, leaders, fresh graduates, leaders, and people managers.

A key pillar of our talent development strategy is the integration of advanced tools and tailored learning pathways. AI-powered tools support every stage of the employee lifecycle – from identifying top candidates whose skills and values align with our

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Talent attraction, retention and development continued

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culture to delivering personalised, skills-based training aligned with individual aspirations and business needs. Real-time feedback systems and data-driven performance analytics enable us to maintain a workplace that is agile, aligned, and responsive to evolving demands.

Compensation at e& is competitive and market-aligned, with salaries regularly reviewed against industry benchmarks to ensure fairness and compliance with local labour laws. By embedding cultural priorities and leveraging technology across all aspects of talent management, we create an environment where employees are empowered to thrive, contribute, and deliver exceptional value. This holistic approach positions e& as a leader in cultivating a dynamic, inclusive, and high-performing workforce ready to meet the challenges of a rapidly evolving business landscape.

Progress in 2024

As one of the UAE's leading companies, e& is deeply committed to attracting, retaining, and developing top talent, recognising the critical role a skilled and engaged workforce plays in driving innovation, business success, and sustainable economic growth. Our approach to talent management is anchored in fairness, transparency, and inclusivity, ensuring that employees feel empowered to thrive in a dynamic and rapidly evolving environment. By embedding advanced technical competencies and cultural alignment across all stages of the employee lifecycle, we

are building a workforce that is not only prepared for the future but also aligned with our strategic transformation goals.

This year, we made significant strides in embedding our One& Culture, a transformative initiative designed to align organisational values and foster employee engagement during our transformation into a global technology company. This culture programme, supported by six behavioural competencies – with two behavioural competencies for each of our three values: Be Customer Obsessed, Unite as One, and Dare to Be Bold – that ensure employees are equipped with the skills and mindset needed to drive success.

Learning and growth

Our talent development initiatives consist of tailored learning pathways that reflect our commitment to fostering leadership, innovation, and technical excellence across all levels of the organisation.

Riyada – high potential employee programme

Towards the end of the year, we kicked-off our Riyada development programme for high-potential employees (HiPo). In collaboration with INSEAD and Biz Group, the six-month customised intensive programme aims to accelerate participant growth and prepare them for a bright future. Participants engage in various learning opportunities, including case discussions and leadership feedback sessions, all tailored to reflect e&'s values, transformation journey and strategic priorities.

She Leads programme

Our She Leads leadership programme for middle management females has been instrumental in advancing gender diversity and fostering inclusivity. This programme was customised to support females who are stepping into leadership positions or preparing to do so, and provides them with the tools and support needed to navigate leadership in a tech landscape.

AI Graduate programme

Emiratization remains a cornerstone of our talent strategy, and our AI Graduate programme continued its momentum this year. The successful onboarding of 60 UAE nationals into our programme highlights our efforts to achieve our broader goal of 60% Emirati representation by 2030. We are committed to developing local talent and contributing to the UAE's economic vision, which includes prioritising gender diversity. In 2024, 62% of our graduate hires were female, and we have had an overall 81% female participation rate since the inception of the AI Graduate programme in 2021.

Nukhbat Al Wattan

Launched in late 2024, our Nukhbat Al Wattan programme offers practical work experience and skill development for Emirati males awaiting their national service training. During this two to six-month gap period, we provide these individuals with opportunities to learn practical applications of work and gain new skills.

Our performance	2021	2022	2023	2024
Total workforce UAE (FTE + outsourced employees)	5,192	6,174	7,210	6,570
Proportion of FTE versus outsourced employees (%)	25	34	45	46
Total of new hires (FTE, external hires)	193	230	182	170
Percentage of positions filled by internal candidates (%)	9	25	30	31
Employee total turnover rate (FTE, %)	5.1	6.9	9.4	13.5
Employee voluntary turnover rate (FTE, %)	3.1	2.8	2.4	2.4
Employee non-voluntary turnover rate (FTE, %)	2.0	4.1	7.0	11.1
Number of employees who took maternity leave/Number who returned to work/Number who were still in employment 12 months after returning (FTE)	42/31/29	38/28/26	56/46/45	59/45/44
Percentage of employees who took paternity leave, out of those entitled to paternity leave (FTE, %)	60.8	65.6	63.2	61
Percentage of employees covered by performance appraisals (FTE, %)	100	100	100	100
Total number of training hours (FTE and outsourced employees)	163,688	188,856	298,686	288,164
Number of hours of training per employees	31.5	30.6	41.4	43.9
CEO pay ratio (annual total compensation for the organisation's highest-paid individual to the median annual total compensation for all employees)	1:47.11	1:34.67	1:33.83	1:32
Sickness absence rate (% of sick days out of total days worked, FTE)	1.1	1.3	1.6	1.7

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Pillar 2 | People and society

Talent attraction, retention and development continued

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AI Programme by Ministry of Cabinet Affairs

In 2024, we sponsored a select number of our top talent to attend and complete the Ministry of Cabinet Affairs AI programme. Nine top talents were nominated and won first place for their capstone project.

Ericsson Excelerate&

In collaboration with Ericsson, we launched the Excelerate& programme to upskill high-potential employees in the youth category on cloud and data monetisation. In 2024, 12 high-potential employees were nominated to participate.

Bidayati – internship programme

We developed Bidayati as a unique internship programme offering students of all academic levels the opportunity to gain professional work experience and engage in live AI projects. In 2024, 212 students participated, including seven Master's degree students from MBZUAI.

Retail store manager programme

Our programme is designed to empower retail sales managers in the UAE with leadership skills to drive performance through coaching and feedback. Participants learn to manage teams effectively in alignment with the e& brand values. In 2024, we delivered 16 sessions to 215 retail store managers, with 99% of participants recommending the training to others.

iQRA

Our iQRA platform is a Group-wide learning platform, which hosts all mandatory and voluntary training across the business.

Engaging our people

Our focus on engagement lies at the heart of our proposition as an employer of choice, as evidenced by an engagement score of 81 out of 100 in our annual survey, a one-point increase from the previous year. Initiatives such as the Viva Suite, which includes tools like Glint and Engage, have enhanced communication, collaboration, and inclusivity across the organisation.

The Innovate& Hub provided a platform for employees to share ideas and solutions, while peer-to-peer recognition programmes fostered a culture of appreciation and collaboration. By listening to employee feedback and addressing areas like work-life balance, recognition, and innovation, we are continuously refining our approach to create an environment where employees feel valued and supported.

Awards and recognition

Our strategic focus on talent attraction, development, and engagement is further reflected in the awards and accolades we received this year, including “Employer of the Year” at the Future Workplace Awards and “HR Team of the Year” at the GCC Gov HR & Youth Awards. These recognitions underscore our leadership in shaping a high-performing, inclusive workforce that is well-positioned to navigate the challenges and opportunities of an ever-evolving business landscape. Through these efforts, we are not only advancing our organisational goals but also fostering a culture of excellence that drives value for our stakeholders and society at large.

Future focus

In 2025, we will focus on advancing our talent strategy by identifying and developing the capabilities required to achieve our 2030 vision. This includes implementing targeted upskilling initiatives to ensure our workforce is prepared to meet the challenges and opportunities of the future. Our culture transformation efforts will be aligned with long-term objectives, fostering a workplace environment that supports new operating models and drives sustained success.

We will also roll out tech-enabled HR practices and frameworks designed to address the individual needs of each employee, creating a personalised HR experience that enhances engagement, satisfaction, and productivity.

To further our Emiratisation agenda, we plan to introduce new hiring programmes aimed at transitioning Nafis and outsourced UAE national employees to full-time roles. We will increase the number of graduates hired through our graduate programme and ensure balanced Emirati representation across all departments and organisational levels, meeting our targets while fostering diversity and inclusion across e&.

Over the long term, we aim to deliver a technology-driven, personalised talent lifecycle that attracts, develops, and retains exceptional talent. By empowering our workforce with the skills and opportunities to thrive, we will position e& to excel in a dynamic, digital-first world.

Our performance	2021	2022	2023	2024
Proportion of local UAE employees (%)	51.2	51.5	52.5	54.3
Proportion of local UAE employees in management (%)	48.5	46.8	44.9	44.4

Proportion of local UAE employees

2024	54.3%
2023	52.5%
2022	51.5%
2021	51.2%



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6 Digital access and inclusion



Our commitment to digital inclusion is about more than connecting people – we are contributing to a world where everyone has equal access to opportunities that drive progress. By breaking down barriers to connectivity and empowering underserved communities with digital tools, we are building a future where innovation, accessibility, and inclusivity fuel sustainable growth and transformation.”

Harrison Lung

Group Chief Strategy Officer

Definition of material matter:

Enabling available, accessible, affordable connectivity and digital solutions in the communities in which we operate.

Why it is material to e&:

Connectivity is at the core of our business activities. By tackling access and inclusion, we can address broader societal challenges while positively impacting our business.

Type of impact:

Providing for connectivity and inclusive digital access, is an enabler for the communities to access essential services such as health, education or finance.

Value chain impact:

- Operations
- Downstream

Key stakeholders:

- Customers
- Business partners
- Community

Our management approach

The digital divide remains a critical challenge, with nearly one-third of the global population lacking network connectivity. This disparity is particularly severe among underrepresented groups, where factors such as gender, age, income, geographical location, and physical ability exacerbate inequality. Similarly, the gap in financial inclusion is stark, with 1.4 billion people worldwide remaining unbanked, depriving them of essential financial resources. These challenges not only hinder access to vital services like healthcare, education, and banking but also stifle economic growth and perpetuate poverty.

Bridging these divides is essential for fostering economic empowerment, social equality, and national growth. Reliable connectivity, combined with affordable and accessible devices, forms the backbone of an inclusive digital ecosystem. Investments in network infrastructure and the development of fintech solutions such as mobile money transfers and microloans can drive financial inclusion in underserved communities, particularly in developing economies. Tailored financial products, informed by telecom infrastructure and customer insights, can further empower individuals by addressing their specific needs and creating a data-rich ecosystem for future innovation.

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Digital access and inclusion continued

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To ensure success, fostering trust within communities is vital. This requires a localised approach, including transparent pricing, simple and clear communication in local languages, reliable customer support, and partnerships with trusted local institutions. By prioritising these measures, digital and financial inclusion initiatives can effectively reach the underserved, fostering sustainable growth and rewriting the rules of inclusion.

Ultimately, the purpose of advancing digital and financial inclusion lies in its ability to empower individuals and businesses, reduce poverty, and promote a more equitable and prosperous future. By integrating connectivity, fintech innovation, and community trust, we can create ecosystems where convenience, empowerment, and economic growth converge.

Progress in 2024

At e&, we contribute to digital access and inclusion through our strategic partnerships and initiatives. During 2024 we made significant progress on our existing commitments, while at the same time seeing a scale up from a number of our companies in products and services to drive financial inclusion.

Our commitment to digital access and inclusion was strengthened through our partnership with the World Economic Forum's EDISON Alliance in 2023. The EDISON Alliance is a global initiative aiming to provide affordable digital access to one billion people by 2025, aligning with our goal of fostering inclusive, equitable digital opportunities. We pledged to impact positively the lives of 30 million people by 2025 through enhanced connectivity, digital financial services, and technology

education. As of the end of 2024, our impact went above and beyond our original pledge, supporting the EDISON Alliance to meet their one billion lives goal over a year ahead of schedule. Ubank and Erada (see case studies) are two examples of our e&'s commitment to the goals of the EDISON alliance, which forms part of our broader focus on ensuring a better society and future through our actions across our markets.

Under our e& Life vertical, the e& Money app has emerged as a vital driver of financial inclusivity, empowering over 1.5 million users, particularly underbanked populations in the UAE. The app facilitates seamless cross-border money transfers to banks, mobile wallets and cash pick-up stations. With a fourfold increase in transaction volumes in 2024 alone, the app has become a lifeline for the unbanked and underbanked, enabling active participation in the digital economy, particularly in regions lacking traditional banking infrastructure. Additionally, the issuance of 900,000 instant Mastercard digital cards has enabled users to conduct safe and convenient transactions, both online and offline, bridging critical gaps in financial access. e& money is a lifeline for populations previously excluded from traditional banking services.

e& Life has expanded its impact in international markets, driving financial inclusion with innovative services tailored to local needs. In Egypt, the launch of e& Neo, the country's first digital banking platform, and e& Cash, which facilitates global wallet-to-wallet

remittances, marked significant milestones in expanding financial access. In Pakistan, the UCash nano-lending service offers access to small loans, empowering underserved populations with the tools they need to manage financial challenges and opportunities

Through our efforts in connectivity, millions of individuals gained access to our networks, representing a significant expansion in mobile subscribers who now benefit from reliable and affordable digital access. With respect to digital financial services, our initiatives empowered users with e-wallets, deposit accounts, and loan facilities, providing them with tools for financial independence and inclusion. These achievements underscore our commitment to creating a digitally inclusive future that transforms lives and drives sustainable progress.

Future focus

At e&, we are shaping the future by empowering digital societies through our networks, products, and solutions. Superior connectivity and innovative digital tools serve as the foundation for tackling some of humanity's most pressing challenges, bridging gaps, and unlocking opportunities across communities.

We believe a truly inclusive digital future means ensuring equitable access to digital skills and technology for all. By enabling individuals with the technical and vocational expertise needed for employment, entrepreneurship, and economic inclusion, we aim to create pathways for sustainable development. Expanding and

strengthening our network connectivity and infrastructure will further enhance access to essential services, improving quality of life and driving economic growth in underserved areas.

As part of this vision, we are committed to measuring and amplifying our impact. In 2025, we will publish our first Social Anchor Goal, a comprehensive framework to quantify e&'s total social contribution and assess the cumulative impact we aim to achieve by 2030. This initiative reflects our dedication to creating meaningful change, empowering societies, and fostering a more inclusive and sustainable digital future for everyone.

[→ Continues](#)

Pillar 2 | People and society

Digital access and inclusion continued

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Case study:

Advancing financial inclusion in Pakistan

In a country where 70% of the population remains unbanked, e& has strategically advanced financial inclusion through our microfinance arm, U Microfinance Bank (U Bank), a wholly owned subsidiary of PTCL Group. Operating over 300 branches primarily in rural areas, U Bank plays a pivotal role in implementing Pakistan's National Financial Inclusion Strategy, which aims to integrate 50% of the adult population into the formal banking sector. By providing accessible microloans, savings programmes, and essential banking services, U Bank is addressing socio-economic barriers and fostering financial empowerment across underserved regions.

U Bank's impact is evident in its rapid expansion, with a loan portfolio that has grown fivefold in just five years, serving over five million depositors and 400,000 loan clients. This strategic focus on rural areas and low-income populations underscores our commitment to leveraging financial innovation for societal good. By bridging the financial inclusion gap, U Bank is driving broader economic growth, aligning with national objectives and reinforcing our role as a leader in fostering sustainable development.

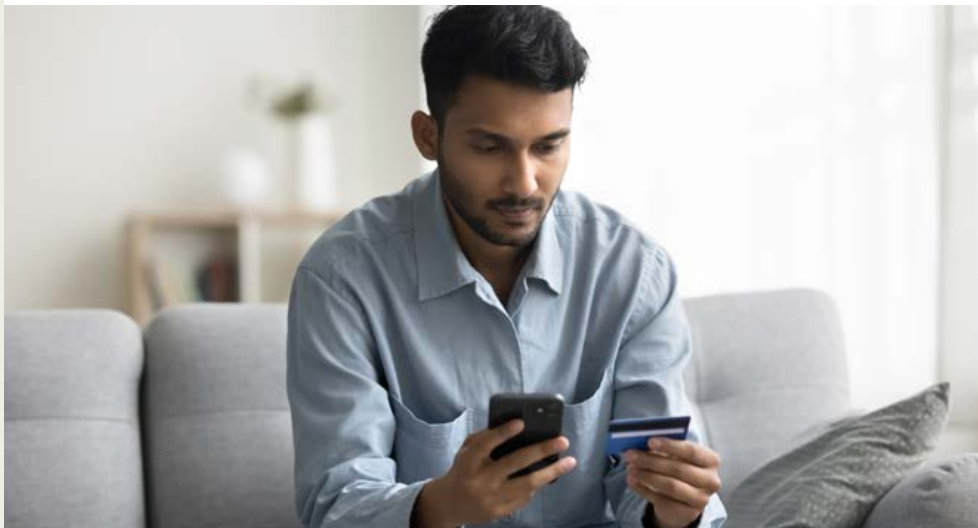
Case study:

Advancing financial inclusion in Egypt



In Egypt, where financial inclusion remains a key national priority, strategic collaborations are driving meaningful progress. e& Egypt, in partnership with The Sovereign Fund of Egypt (TSFE), launched Erada Microfinance to address critical financial inclusion gaps. Aligned with Egypt's Vision 2030, Erada leverages digital technologies to deliver innovative lending solutions to underserved MSMEs. By streamlining loan applications and enabling digital disbursements and repayments, Erada has empowered over 25,000 clients and approved close to EGP 750 million in loans within its first year, marking a significant milestone in fostering economic inclusion and youth empowerment.

This initiative exemplifies our strategic commitment to creating transformative impact through digital and financial inclusion. As part of our pledge to the EDISON Alliance, we enhanced access to essential financial services, driving economic growth and sustainable development across key markets. Through partnerships like Erada, we have demonstrated our commitment to building inclusive ecosystems that fuel progress and opportunity for communities and businesses alike.



Pillar 2 | People and society

Digital access and inclusion continued

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Case study:

Inspiring the next generation of digital innovators



Demonstrating our commitment to fostering digital literacy and innovation, we conducted a series of impactful coding and AI training sessions for students and teachers. Organised in collaboration with EBTIC, these sessions attracted over 2,500 registrants, with individual courses engaging hundreds of participants. For example, our session on AI use cases drew over 560 attendees, while programming with Python brought in 553 participants. The enthusiastic feedback and high attendance numbers underscore the growing interest and need for such programmes, as well as our success in delivering meaningful educational experiences.

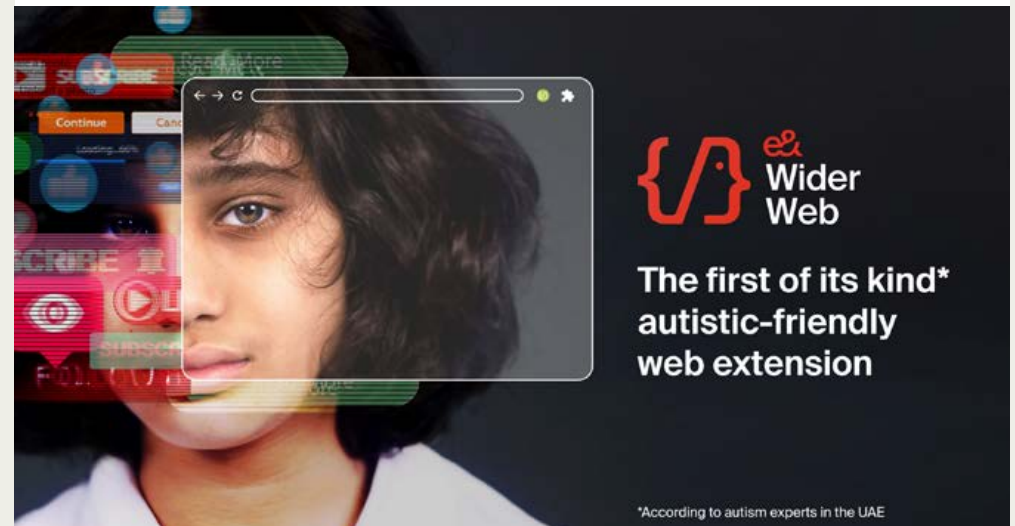
By providing hands-on training and practical knowledge, we are equipping participants with the skills necessary to navigate the digital age confidently. This initiative reflects our commitment to shaping a future-ready workforce while supporting the UAE's vision of technological advancement. As we continue to expand access to high-quality digital education, these programmes are helping to bridge skill gaps, inspire innovation, and prepare students and educators for the opportunities of tomorrow.

Case study:

Transforming digital accessibility with wider web for mobile

We expanded our groundbreaking accessibility initiative with the launch of the “Wider Web” browser extension for mobile devices, coinciding with World Autism Awareness Day. Designed to provide autistic users with a customisable, sensory-friendly browsing experience, this free-to-use tool empowers individuals to navigate the internet with greater ease and confidence. Building on the success of our original Wider Web extension for desktop, introduced in 2021 in collaboration with the Ministry of Community Development, this mobile expansion underscores our commitment to digital inclusion and innovation.

By transforming standard web pages into autistic-friendly experiences, the Wider Web extension represents a powerful collaboration between e&, local psychologists, and individuals on the autism spectrum. As an open-source technology, it invites contributors from around the world to drive its ongoing enhancement and adoption. Initiatives like Wider Web reflect our broader mission to create inclusive digital experiences, ensuring that everyone has equal access to the opportunities of the digital age while reinforcing our leadership in advancing accessibility and social responsibility.



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7 Health and safety



At e&, health, safety, and environmental responsibility are more than just priorities — they are part of who we are. We believe that integrating HSE into our broader strategy strengthens our ability to operate responsibly, protect our people, and contribute to a sustainable future. By fostering a strong safety culture, mitigating risks, and prioritising well-being, we create a workplace where employees, contractors, and communities can thrive. With internationally recognised policies and a commitment to continuous improvement, we ensure that operational excellence and environmental stewardship remain at the heart of everything we do.”

Obaid Bokisha
Group Chief Operations Officer

Definition of material matter:

Health, Safety, and Environment (HSE) entails comprehensive policies and practices to ensure the security, safety and well-being of our workforce and anyone entering our premises or affected by our operations, in accordance with applicable laws.

Why it is material to e&:

The health and safety of our employees and contractors is a top priority, aligning with our commitment to providing a secure and conducive working environment. It is integral to our corporate responsibility and supports the sustainable and ethical operation of our business.

Type of impact:

The impact is actual, considering the tangible and measurable influence of health and safety policies on our operations and stakeholders across the value chain. It is overwhelmingly positive, constituting an opportunity to create a secure work environment, build trust among stakeholders and enhance our corporate reputation.

Value chain impact:

- Upstream
- Operations
- Downstream

Key stakeholders:

- Customers
- Employees
- Business partners
- Shareholders
- Community
- Local and national authorities

Policies:

- [e& Group Occupational Health and Safety Policy](#)
- [e& Code of Conduct](#)
- [e& Supplier Code of Ethical Conduct](#)

Our management approach

At e&, we uphold the highest standards of workplace health and safety, ensuring compliance with all relevant laws and safe labour practices. Our Occupational Health and Safety (OHS) policy covers all relevant stakeholders, including workers, suppliers, contractors, consultants, guests, and partners. It mandates strict adherence to safety regulations and immediate reporting of any infractions as per our Code of Conduct. We prioritise hazard prevention and encourage reporting of issues to on-site security or reception. In case of an incident, we have a dedicated and documented investigation process.

We have a dedicated HSE Committee composed of Senior Vice Presidents from across the Group. Our Corporate HSE team leads health and safety efforts within the organisation daily as part of our broader operations team, which is led by the Group Chief Operations Officer who reports to the Group CEO. In 2024, e& made significant advances in health and safety governance, including the implementation of the HSE governance model for OpCos in Afghanistan and Pakistan, which is strengthening operational control and ensuring alignment with corporate standards by empowering representatives from various departments and business units to act as safety champions that promote HSE best practices in their respective areas.

→ Continues

Pillar 2 | People and society

Health and safety continued

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We maintain a robust Occupational Health and Safety Management System (OHSMS) aligned with ISO 45001:2018 standards, demonstrating our commitment to best practices. Through collaboration with our Business Excellence team, we continuously benchmark our HSE performance against global industry standards. Key initiatives include our HSE Empowerment programme, aimed at fostering a strong safety culture, enhancing emergency preparedness, and improving the rigour of our safety documentation. This comprehensive approach underscores our dedication to providing a safe and secure working environment for all employees.

Progress in 2024

As always, the health and safety of our people remained a top priority for e& during 2024. Throughout the year, we further embedded a “safety-first culture” across the organisation through the launch of our HSE Ambassadors programme, while our new “Stop Work and Improvement Notice” process enhanced compliance and operational efficiency.

A range of employee engagement initiatives included extensive training programmes, fire warden certifications, HSE Centre of Excellence (COE) sessions for senior staff, and the introduction of the HSE Viva Engage platform for enhanced collaboration. Meanwhile, health and wellness campaigns, including hypertension awareness, no-smoking initiatives, and breast cancer awareness, engaged hundreds of employees, while the “Beat the Heat” campaign achieved

record participation. Furthermore, the revamped HSE website provided updated resources, while operationally, we experienced zero incidents of high-consequence work-related injuries, and 100% compliance with the UAE’s mid-day break rule was achieved.

We officially launched the e& Ambassadors Programme, bringing together 20 members from various departments and business units. This initiative fosters cross-functional collaboration and engagement, with plans for further expansion in the coming days to strengthen its impact across the organisation.

Throughout the year, over 300 fire wardens across our UAE operations underwent external training and certification in first aid and basic firefighting. This initiative enhances emergency preparedness, ensuring a safer work environment and strengthening our overall response capabilities.

In addition, this year saw significant operational and safety risks that required effective focus, planning and coordination to successfully navigate. These included operational and safety risks from unexpected floods and heavy rains and ensuring uniform compliance with newly introduced processes, which required extensive coordination and training across all organisational levels.

Furthermore, the health and safety risks associated with rigging, network maintenance, and the upkeep of high-rise buildings remained significant in 2024, but with evolving dynamics and new mitigation strategies we have been able to

manage them more effectively. Our multi-pronged approach included enhanced, specialised training programmes covering specific risks like fall protection, electrical safety, and equipment handling, with mandatory certifications for high-risk tasks. We further improved our work permit system to enforce hazard-specific precautions and upgraded PPE policies ensured the availability and proper usage of essential safety gear across all worksites.

Our automation efforts progressed with the completion of two “Hayyak modules” for inspections and audits and the permit-to-work system, with a third module for the accident incident register in development. We continued our rigorous oversight of contractors and subcontractors, including strict adherence to the Supplier Code of Conduct and HSE standards, which further strengthened risk management measures.

Significant progress was made in certifications, including the certification of the ISO 45001:2018 project for 10 high-rise buildings (HRBs), successful recertification of ISO 14001 for main buildings, and ISO 9001 accreditation for the Business Management System in the UAE.

In addition, our progress and commitment was recognised by the British Safety Council International Safety Awards, which commended our dedication to maintaining high standards of health, safety, and well-being.

Our performance	2021	2022	2023	2024
Total number of health and safety training hours provided to employees	6,742	9,564	9,789	13,089
Number of recordable work-related injuries – employees	0	1	2	4
Number of high-consequence work-related injuries (excluding fatalities) – employees	0	0	0	0
Number of fatalities – employees	0	0	0	0
Number of recordable work-related injuries – contractors	2	2	5	6
Number of high-consequence work-related injuries (excluding fatalities) – contractors	0	0	0	0
Number of fatalities – contractors	0	0	0	0

As part of our commitment to employee well-being and community health, we organised four blood donation drives at different locations across the UAE. These drives saw excellent participation from our staff members and other contributors, supporting healthcare needs while fostering a culture of social responsibility within our organisation.

In collaboration with leading healthcare providers in the UAE, we established three clinic facilities within our offices. These clinics enhance access to medical services for our employees, supporting workplace health and well-being through convenient and quality healthcare.

Total number of H&S training hours

2024	13,089
2023	9,789
2022	9,564
2021	6,742

e& was honoured with the Health & Well-Being Programme - Platinum Award (GESGA 2024) in recognition of our eClub, a dedicated recreation club for staff and their families. This award highlights our ongoing efforts to promote employee well-being by providing inclusive recreational and wellness initiatives that enhance work-life balance and foster a healthier community.

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Pillar 2 | People and society

Health and safety continued

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Health and safety of our customers and local communities

e& prioritises the health and safety of our customers and the communities we serve by embedding robust risk management strategies across all facets of our operations, products, and services.

Our operations: We conduct rigorous risk assessments, focusing on high-hazard areas like construction, equipment handling, and field operations. This proactive approach includes enhanced PPE protocols, robust work permit systems, and specialised training to minimise risks. Our robust incident management framework ensures prompt identification, investigation, and rectification of safety incidents, including root cause analysis and the implementation of corrective actions.

Our products and services: We integrate HSE considerations into product design, ensuring compliance with global safety standards and minimising risks to end-users and maintenance personnel. We proactively assess the environmental and human health impacts of emerging technologies, such as radiation emissions from telecom towers and e-waste management, to mitigate potential risks.

Our business relationships: We incorporate HSE due diligence into all M&A activities, ensuring acquired entities align with our stringent HSE standards. We maintain strong relationships with contractors and suppliers, requiring them to adhere to our HSE policies and conducting regular evaluations to ensure compliance. High-risk activities involving third parties are closely monitored to prevent occupational hazards.

Future focus

In 2025, we will seek to advance our HSE standards by aligning with global best practices, including a major gap analysis using the British Safety Council 5-Star Audit criteria to benchmark and pursue certification. Key priorities include strengthening governance frameworks, ensuring uniform compliance, and enhancing employee engagement through innovative training and wellness initiatives. By leveraging data-driven insights, refining processes, and integrating automation modules into the Hayyak platform, we aim to enhance operational excellence, maintain zero-incident targets, and reinforce e&'s position as a global leader in HSE and sustainability practices.

Beat the heat campaign



Fire safety demonstration at the HSE Centre of Excellence



Fire Warden Appreciation Ceremony

Pillar 2 | People and society

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8 Community engagement



At e&, we are steadfast in our commitment to fostering meaningful community engagement and driving impactful CSR initiatives across the Group. By aligning our efforts with local needs and global priorities, we aim to build stronger, more inclusive communities for a sustainable future.”

Andrew Dunnett

Group Senior Vice President of Sustainability

Definition of material matter:

e&'s impact on the people who live in the regions where it operates.

Why it is material to e&:

As one of the most valuable telecommunications brands in the region, e& has a responsibility to uplift and support the citizens that it serves. e&'s licence to operate is granted by our communities.

Type of impact:

Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) activities support employee engagement and motivation, contribute positively to ESG ratings, increase support from regulatory and government bodies, and enhance brand identity, trust and reputation.

Value chain impact:

- Operations
- Downstream

Key stakeholders:

- Customers
- Employees
- Shareholders
- Community
- Local and national authorities

Policies:

- e& Corporate Social Responsibility Policy

Our management approach

Our management approach to Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) reflects a commitment to both societal impact and employee engagement. e&'s CSR team, which now sits within our Sustainability function leads our community programme, including our philanthropic efforts and partnerships, supporting the UAE national agenda, and managing our employee volunteers. We continuously monitor feedback from these engagements to refine our approach and maximise our social impact.

The team also monitors our CSR programmes across the Group and wherever we operate we align our efforts with national priorities and global frameworks such as the GSMA, the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), and the UN Global Compact (UNGC). We recognise that volunteering fosters staff engagement, as evidenced by the 850+ employees registered in our volunteer registry. We believe that our CSR efforts must cater to the needs of the local communities where we operate. In the UAE, our CSR programme is built on key pillars and themes, which we will look to refresh in the coming year to deliver an enhanced and more targeted impact.

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Pillar 2 | People and society

Community engagement continued

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Pillars and themes



Philanthropic and humanitarian responsibility

We partner with the UAE government, charity organisations and NGOs for maximum impact



Volunteering

By providing our employees with opportunities to volunteer, we enhance the sense of giving and participation among our own teams



Society development

We support the national agenda and initiatives



Social impact

We empower people with disabilities, start-ups and incubators



Connect

As a technological organisation, we can empower and train (students and teachers) in technology, cybersecurity, coding, blockchain, etc.

Each of e& group's Operating Companies defines their own approach to CSR, aligning community engagements with initiatives that are relevant to their countries and the communities they serve.

Progress in 2024

We redefined our approach to community engagement in 2024 by developing a revitalised CSR programme for the UAE, structured around clearly defined pillars and focus areas to deliver greater, more strategic impact. This transformation reflects our commitment to fostering meaningful change and aligns with the integration of our CSR function under the Group Sustainability team, ensuring a holistic approach to sustainable development. Our initiatives this year have reinforced our position as a catalyst for

progress, addressing critical social, environmental, and healthcare challenges through innovative and impactful programmes.

Our partnerships with organisations like the Make-A-Wish Foundation and Emirates Red Crescent enabled us to support critical causes, including granting wishes for children with life-threatening illnesses and providing essential aid to communities in need. Through strategic campaigns such as "Gaza in Our Hearts", we channelled resources to deliver food and shelter to Gaza's residents, while our collaboration with Ma'an strengthened medical research and healthcare initiatives in the UAE. Our Ramadan programmes, including "Grant a Wish" and our support for the Emirates Red Crescent's Iftar

project, reflected our dedication to fostering hope and well-being during the holy month.

We prioritised education, inclusion, and sustainability as pillars of our social responsibility strategy. Our initiatives like the "[Wider Web](#)" [browser extension](#) for autistic users underscored our commitment to digital inclusion, ensuring accessibility for all.

For a second year in a row, we partnered with the Ministry of Education and Emirates ICT Innovation Centre (EBTIC) to conduct coding sessions for over 2,500 students and teachers, covering AI, Python programming, web development, and telecom network optimization. By hosting coding sessions and innovation showcases for students, we inspired the next generation to embrace technology's transformative potential. On a global scale, our involvement in events such as World MS Day and the National Carbon Sequestration Project highlighted our leadership in raising awareness, fostering community engagement, and advancing sustainability goals. Every initiative we support reflects our vision to empower communities, protect the planet, and create opportunities for a brighter, more inclusive future.

In Egypt, e& Egypt's approach to community engagement exemplifies our commitment to creating meaningful, lasting impact by aligning CSR efforts with local priorities. Focused on technology, healthcare, and community well-being, we leverage partnerships and sustainability principles to address

Our performance	2021	2022	2023	2024
Overall contribution to community work (AED million)	24.3	25.8	29.16	27.644
Number of volunteering hours	n/a*	200	2716	100**
Number of volunteers amongst employees	n/a*	600	510	857

* No volunteering due to COVID in 2021

** Reduced hours due to reduced requests for volunteers by external entities

pressing challenges and drive progress. Through tailored initiatives like Seha-Tech, we aim to transform critical sectors, foster innovation, and contribute to a more equitable and prosperous future for the communities we serve.

In the UAE, our CSR efforts earned prestigious recognition in 2024, including recognition by the Ministry of Climate Change and Environment for our contributions to the National Carbon Sequestration Project, which included planting 53,000 Ghaf trees this year. This was achieved in collaboration with multiple government and private entities, contributing to biodiversity conservation, carbon sequestration, and local ecosystem restoration. Aligning with our broader climate and environmental goals, reinforcing our commitment to sustainability and ecological resilience.

We were proud that the Ministry of Health and Prevention commended our support for the Nabdak initiative, promoting early detection of heart diseases. Dubai Cares also recognised our role in the "Gaza in Our Hearts" campaign, highlighting our dedication to meaningful change and community value.

Future focus

In 2025, we will launch our new CSR programme, scaling up initiatives in the UAE to drive greater social impact. This will include introducing innovative projects and strengthening existing programmes to align more closely with community needs.

Additionally, we look to assess our social impact, integrating our CSR efforts into a broader sustainability framework that reflects our commitment to accountability and meaningful progress.

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Pillar 2 | People and society

Community engagement continued

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Building brighter futures:

e& and Abu Dhabi's Early Childhood Week

e& partnered with the Abu Dhabi Early Childhood Authority (ECA) to support Abu Dhabi Early Childhood Week, a transformative event designed to elevate the importance of early childhood development (ECD) across the Emirate. Anchored in themes like Intentional Parenting, Culture and Identity, and Sustainable, Family-Friendly Cities, the initiative fostered innovation, collaboration, and investment to address pressing challenges in ECD. The week brought together key players, from investors to researchers, showcasing cutting-edge research, groundbreaking solutions, and impactful startups to shape the future of child-centric development in Abu Dhabi and beyond.

Our participation reflected e&'s unwavering commitment to protecting children's rights, promoting their well-being, and ensuring a brighter future for the next generation. This alignment with our CSR strategy enabled us to contribute to meaningful goals, such as empowering families through intentional parenting, bridging cultural values with global perspectives, and advocating for sustainable, child-friendly urban design. Together with partners like Mubadala, Aldar, and the Department of Culture and Tourism, we delivered an event that resonated with the community and solidified our leadership in driving impactful societal change.

The event's success was profound, engaging over 25,000 families and young children and involving 1,000 global attendees from diverse sectors. Key highlights included 54 workshops, 27 interactive sessions, and 11 innovation outputs, along with 17 Emirates-wide activations, 4 official reports and 15 successful cross-sectoral partnerships, all contributing to the advancement of ECD. These achievements showcased the potential for collaboration to create child-focused solutions, leaving a lasting impression on the community and advancing Abu Dhabi's position as a leader in early childhood innovation.

Event engagement

25,000

families engaged

Workshops

54

Her Excellency Sana Suhail, current Minister of Family in the UAE, and previous Director General of Abu Dhabi Early Childhood Authority, speaking at Abu Dhabi's Early Childhood Week



Pillar 2 | People and society

Community engagement continued

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Empowering healthcare:

e& Egypt's Seha-Tech initiative

At e&, we believe public engagement, community development and CSR must address the unique needs of the communities we serve. e& Egypt exemplifies this ethos by aligning its CSR and Foundation efforts with local priorities to create a meaningful and lasting impact. Guided by pillars of technology, health, and employee engagement, e& Egypt Foundation has prioritised initiatives that advance healthcare, foster innovation, and improve community well-being.

A cornerstone of this commitment is the Seha-Tech programme, launched in partnership with Siemens Healthineers Academy, Ahl Elkheir NGO, and e& Business. Running from 2024 to 2028, the initiative aims to transform healthcare at El Kasr Al Eini New Educational Hospital through three key pillars: digital transformation, health-tech training and medical education, and social development. Notable achievements include training over 60 medical professionals at the hospital, resulting in knowledge gains of up to 74%, and implementing a health information system (HIS) to improve operational efficiency and inter-departmental communication.

Additionally, the programme is set to renovate the hospital's kidney dialysis unit, enhancing the experience for patients and setting new benchmarks in healthcare quality.

e& Egypt and e& Egypt Foundation tailored approach reflects our commitment to leveraging local expertise and partnerships to address pressing challenges and unlock new opportunities for growth. By embedding sustainability principles into our strategy and aligning CSR and development initiatives with community needs, we aim to contribute to a more prosperous and equitable future for Egypt.

Training

>60

medical professionals

“

At e& Egypt Foundation, we believe technology should transform lives, not just systems. Seha-Tech initiative beautifully combines healthcare diagnostics with educational access, embodying our vision of technology as a force that enriches people's lives, one community at a time.”

Ahmed Yehia

e& Egypt Foundation General Secretary and CEO Fintech and Digital Lifestyle at e& Egypt



Pillar 3 | Operating responsibly

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9 Ethical business practices



In a rapidly evolving world driven by disruptive technologies, the key to our success lies in a steadfast commitment to ethics and integrity, which serves as the foundation of trust with our stakeholders. By fostering a culture of accountability and transparency, we empower our people to uphold the highest standards, ensuring every action contributes to meaningful progress, sustainable growth, and a future defined by trust and responsibility.”

Brooke Lindsay

Group Chief Legal and Compliance Officer

Definition of material matter:

Our commitment to conduct business with the highest standards of ethics and integrity, in compliance with applicable laws.

Why it is material to e&:

Core to our business success, our reputation and the trust of our customers is the way in which we conduct our business, based on sound ethical business practices across our value chain and the geographies in which we operate.

Type of impact:

Without a consistent and structured ethical and compliance programme, we risk losing our licence to operate and the trust of our stakeholders.

Value chain impact:

- Upstream
- Operations
- Downstream

Key stakeholders:

- Customers
- Employees
- Business partners
- Shareholders
- Community
- Local and national authorities

Policies:

- e& Code of Conduct
- e& Supplier Code of Ethical Conduct
- e& Anti-bribery and Anti-Corruption Policy
- e& Gifts, Entertainment and Hospitality Policy
- e& Conflict of Interest Policy
- e& Third-Party Risk Management Policy
- e& Sanctions Policy

Our management approach

At the core of e&'s Ethics and Compliance programme is our e& Group Code of Conduct, supported by a comprehensive set of policies that establish the principles guiding our business practices: transparency, fairness, and strict adherence to legal and regulatory frameworks.

This programme is spearheaded by our Group Chief Legal and Compliance Officer (GCLCO) and monitored by the Group Ethics and Compliance Steering Committee, which includes 10 senior executives chaired by the Group CEO, with key members such as the GCIA & RO and the GCFO. At the Board level, the Audit Committee holds oversight responsibility for the Ethics and Compliance framework and receives regular updates from the GCLCO on its progress and implementation. The Audit Committee approves all new Group Ethics and Compliance policies prior to publication.

Our Ethics and Compliance team plays an instrumental role in integrating the ethics and compliance standards in the e& business operations, providing guidance to our employees and improving systems to enable sound business decision making. To ensure that our company policies are responsive to emerging and material ethics and compliance risks, we conduct regular compliance reviews. The team continuously updates and

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Pillar 3 | Operating responsibly

Ethical business practices continued

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refines policies, monitoring mechanisms, control systems, and training programmes to ensure adherence to ethical practices across the organisation and with third parties.

Our annual ethics risk assessment, conducted internally and validated through an external survey, serves as a barometer for the performance of our ethical culture. This year's results signal an improvement in the maturity of our ethics and compliance culture, with improved awareness and a strong commitment towards embracing our ethical standards across the organisation. This enhanced commitment is evident in the heightened engagement observed across various platforms, with an increase in the utilisation of our ethics and compliance advice line, and declaration of conflict of interests, gifts, and hospitality.

Moreover, our strategic communication initiatives, both digital and face to face, have successfully driven higher interaction rates, as evidenced by the increased volume of views and comments. These positive developments underscore our ongoing dedication to fostering an ethical workplace and affirm the effectiveness of our strategies in embedding strong compliance and ethical standards throughout our corporate ecosystem.

Commitment to anti-corruption

We enforce a strict zero-tolerance policy towards corruption and bribery, reflecting our unwavering commitment to robust compliance practices. Our Anti-Bribery and Anti-Corruption and Conflict of Interests policies include a thorough risk assessment process,

backed by strong control measures and internal monitoring activities, support our effort to address and mitigate identified risks. All employees, suppliers, and business partners, attest their compliance with our e& Group Ethics and Compliance policies, including our Anti-Bribery and Anti-Corruption Policy, during their respective onboarding processes. This serves as their commitment to conducting any business dealings with e& in a legal and ethical manner. These efforts align with the realities faced by a business of our size and industry, ensuring such risks are effectively managed.

Upholding fair competition

e& is dedicated to fostering fair competition and combating anti-competitive practices in compliance with relevant laws and regulations. To reinforce this commitment, we conduct mandatory, tailored training programmes and awareness initiatives for employees. These sessions cover essential competition policies and practices, equipping staff with the knowledge needed to operate ethically within the broader legal and regulatory landscape.

Progress in 2024

During the year, we made significant progress in embedding ethics and compliance across our operations, reflecting our commitment to maintaining the highest standards of integrity. A key highlight was the successful launch of two new eLearning modules – Anti-Bribery & Anti-Corruption and Economic Sanctions & Export Controls – with both achieving exceptional completion rates of 98% and 99%, respectively as of year-end. Both eLearning modules

were delivered in English and Arabic, to ensure inclusivity and accessibility for our diverse workforce.

We conducted impactful ethics and compliance campaigns that addressed key risks, fostering a relatable and engaging dialogue with employees and stakeholders. Additionally, we implemented responsible AI standards and frameworks to support our transformation into a global technology company, aligning our innovation with ethical principles.

Driving our core values of customer obsession, unity, and boldness, we strengthened the ethical culture essential to delivering value across our value chain. Retaining our ISO 37001 Anti-Bribery Management System certification further reinforced our standing as a leader in anti-corruption measures.

We also digitised the hospitality management system for the F1 Grand Prix, showcasing how technology can enhance transparency and accountability in large-scale events. Furthermore, we expanded the ethics and compliance infrastructure across growing markets while seamlessly integrating acquisitions such as PPF Telecom and Careem, ensuring our ethical framework supports business growth and transformation.

Future focus

As we enter 2025, our focus will be on supporting e&'s aims as a growing global technology leader. We will leverage the exponential growth of AI, automation and other disruptive technologies, not only to drive internal efficiency but also to unlock new business models and revenue

Our performance	2021	2022	2023	2024
Percentage of employees trained on our Code of Conduct (%)	n/a*	n/a*	99.8	99.8
Percentage of employees that the organisation's anti-corruption policies and procedures have been communicated to**	n/a	n/a	n/a	100%
Percentage of employees receiving anti-corruption training**	n/a	n/a	n/a	98.2
Percentage of employees who have attested to ethics and compliance policies**	n/a	n/a	n/a	97%
Number concerns brought to the whistleblowing line	59	69	81	71
Number of cases investigated	53	67	80	77
Number of substantiated cases	36	35	38	42

* 2021 and 2022 data were computed differently. Data is comparable from 2023 onwards

** Newly introduced metric to be reported from 2024 onwards, includes the introduction of revised ABAC e-Learning launched in 2024.

streams. For our Group Compliance programme, this means not only harnessing these technologies, such as AI, to be more effective and efficient but also helping the business to tackle the legal and compliance challenges these emerging technologies present.

We will continue to drive innovative compliance solutions, including adding training and awareness to our compliance suite that prepares and engages our employees on the ethical application of AI to mitigate risks around bias, fairness, and transparency – all while supporting responsible technology adoption across the business. We will roll out a refreshed Code of Conduct eLearning module that incorporates our new values, further embedding ethical principles throughout our organisation.

We will enhance and integrate our digital compliance tools into a unified Governance, Risk, and Compliance (GRC) platform. This streamlined system will optimise our processes, improve efficiencies, and strengthen our ability to manage key ethics and compliance risks effectively.

Aligning and enhancing the ethics and compliance programmes of our recent acquisitions is a top priority. We will ensure consistent policies, programmes, reporting, and a unified ethical culture across all entities, creating a seamless and aligned approach across the Group.

To reinforce credibility and independence in our compliance efforts, we plan to conduct independent Anti-Bribery and

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Pillar 3 | Operating responsibly

Ethical business practices continued

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Anti-Corruption (ABAC) risk assessments for our operating companies. This will further strengthen our governance and enhance the effectiveness of our risk management processes.

Our speak up line

e&'s whistle-blow channels encourage everyone to disclose immediately any wrongdoings that may adversely impact e& Group.

e& speak-up process promotes openness in the workplace and encourages employees to report instances of unethical behaviour, actual or suspected fraud, and violation of e&'s policies and processes. Supported by our whistle-blowing policy and guidelines, it is a formal whistle-blowing system with legal protection, managed by the Risk & Assurance department.

In e&, we have an averse appetite for any fraud involving our employees, contractors or any other third party working for or on behalf of e& Group, and the resultant action will be dependent on the severity and nature of the case. Employees and external stakeholders can report their concerns by email, phone, regular mail or through internal whistle-blow physical boxes available on premise, with an option to remain anonymous. Concerns can pertain to issues, such as; financial or non-financial maladministration, fraud that has been or is likely to be committed, unethical behaviour, misuse of authority, leakage of confidential information, noncompliance with laws and regulations, favouring a specific supplier/contractor, or discrimination against any member of staff or

customers. The whistleblowing process guarantees confidentiality and protects those reaching out from retaliation.

Raised concerns are managed in accordance with our internal policies and guidelines, such as the Global Whistle-blow (GWB) policy, which specify the whole process from concern registration and log into the system right through investigation, reporting and closure. The GWB policy is not a standalone policy but compliments other e& Group policies such as code of conduct, suppliers' code of conduct, compliance and ethics policies. The GWB policy undergoes annual revisions to address organisational changes, adoption of new international standards, or any necessary changes deemed necessary for the effectiveness of the policy.

In 2024, a total of 71 incident reports were received by the Risk & Assurance department through the whistleblowing channels, compared to 81 received in 2023. A total of 77 investigations, comprising from incidents reported in 2024 and carried forward from 2023, were completed. Out of which, 42 investigations were substantiated and pertained mainly to non-compliances to policies and procedures, customer care, non-fraud (grievances/behavioural complaints), conflict of interest and corruption cases that resulted in disciplinary measures ranging from advice letters to dismissals, and control improvement recommendations.

Within our supply chain, we expect our suppliers to provide an anonymous complaint mechanism for workers and managers to report any grievances and to take measures to protect whistleblower confidentiality and prohibit retaliation.

Suppliers may report a violation or breach of the Supplier Code via: whistleblower@eand.com.

Stakeholders may report any misconduct through the UAE Accountability Authority (UAEAA), an independent entity dedicated to enhancing transparency and accountability across various sectors in the UAE. The UAEAA provides a secure platform for reporting misconduct or malpractice without fear of retaliation, overseeing enforcement and compliance. This authority plays a crucial role in maintaining integrity and public trust in both governmental and private institutions.

Proactive fraud risk management

At e&, several proactive fraud risk management initiatives are systematically implemented to strengthen the integrity and security of our operations. Among these initiatives, Fraud Awareness Week stands out as a key annual campaign, observed across all the entities within the e& Group, domestically and internationally. This event marks a joint effort to educate and engage employees on the importance of fraud prevention. We have recently celebrated our fourth successful Fraud Awareness Week, involving not only the e& Group but also its OpCos and subsidiaries, reinforcing our commitment to fraud awareness across the board.

In addition to awareness campaigns, we have established a comprehensive Fraud Risk Assessment programme that spans all operations. This programme integrates data analytics capabilities, enhancing our ability to detect and respond to potential fraud effectively. The primary aim of this initiative is to pinpoint potential vulnerabilities within the organisation and evaluate the effectiveness of existing controls designed to mitigate fraud risks. To further bolster these efforts, a three-year strategy has been approved by the Audit Committee, which will guide our actions and initiatives in the coming years.

Moreover, we facilitate Fraud Forums and Roundtable meetings within the e& footprint (e& Group, OpCos, and subsidiaries). These forums serve as platforms for knowledge exchange and collaboration among employees, fostering a culture of transparency and vigilance. Finally, an annual one-day anti-fraud conference is organised where Special Audit and Fraud Management experts across e& footprint, meet and showcase latest trends, discussions on fraud scenarios, brainstorming and socialising. Through these collective efforts, we continue to strengthen our defences against fraud, ensuring robust protection for our assets and maintaining trust with our stakeholders.

Grievance management at e&

At e&, we are deeply committed to upholding the highest standards of transparency and accountability, ensuring that employees and stakeholders have clear channels to voice grievances. We provide robust

mechanisms outlined in our Code of Conduct, Supplier Code of Conduct, and HR Manual, which detail how impacted individuals can communicate their concerns. Employees are encouraged to report any suspected unethical or illegal activities through various platforms, including direct communication with their line managers, HR Business Partners, the Ethics and Compliance department, or via a confidential whistleblower hotline and email service. e& maintains a strict zero-tolerance policy for retaliation, ensuring employees can speak up without fear of reprisal. All reports, even those unsubstantiated, are taken seriously, and those raising concerns in good faith are protected.

Our grievance management approach ensures all issues are resolved fairly and promptly. Performance-related grievances, such as concerns about career progression or reviews, and non-performance grievances, including misconduct or interpersonal disputes, are addressed through a clear, tiered process. Employees are first encouraged to resolve grievances informally with their line managers. If unresolved, the matter can be escalated to the HR Business Partner, department heads, or, in severe cases, the HR Policy and Governance team. For serious misconduct, the Investigation Committee, appointed by the GCHRO or GCEO, evaluates cases to determine appropriate disciplinary measures. This structured approach reflects our commitment to fostering a supportive and transparent work environment.

Pillar 3 | Operating responsibly

Ethical business practices continued

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“Tone at the top” is a key part of the Compliance Programme, as many of the initiatives and standards that underpin our compliance culture require endorsement by the senior leaders to be successfully adopted across the organisation.

In September, our Group Director for Ethics interviewed the Group Chief People Officer and the Group Chief Legal and Compliance Officer about our new values in a short video. These messages help employees understand the context and importance of our culture change, the relevance of the refreshed values to their work, and their impact on our reputation. This initiative aims to engage and inspire employees, promote ethical behaviour, and embed these values into our Company culture.

Our Ethics and Compliance programme emphasises cascading values from leadership. Throughout the year we also recorded and produced multiple tone at the top messages from key leaders across the business, including the e& UAE CEO, Masood Sharif, the e& enterprise company Beehive Fintech CEO, Craig Moore and the Etisalat Services Holding (ESH) CEO, Muammer Al Rukhaimi, showcasing their commitment to bringing our Compliance Culture to life.

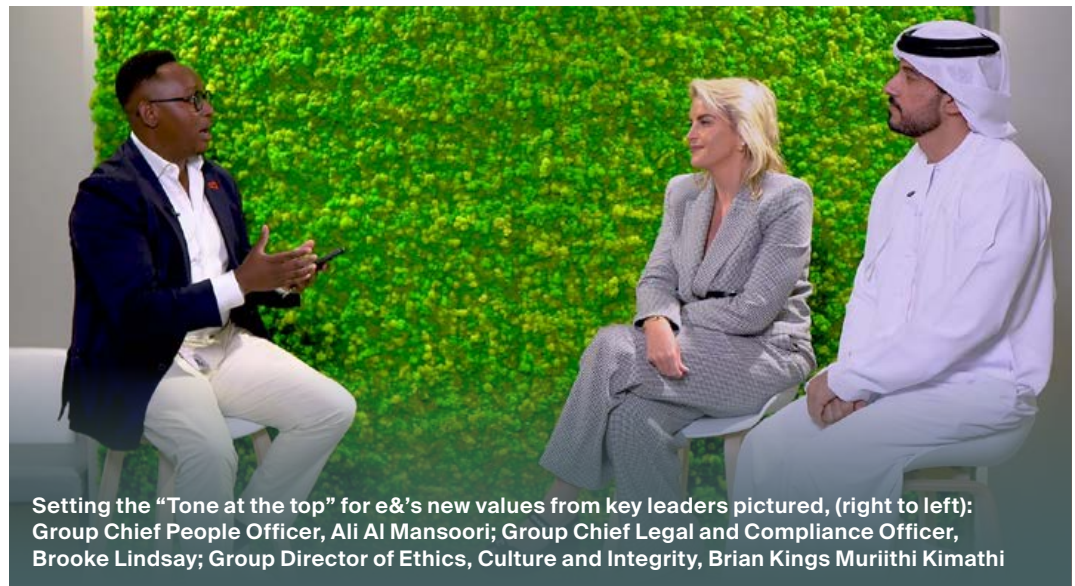
We capped off a busy year by hosting over 100 attendees from across the e& footprint at our biggest ever annual e& Legal and Compliance Forum.

The event was spread across two days of in-person events designed to connect both the legal and compliance communities. It further served as the seventh edition of the e& Annual Compliance Day to mark International Anti-Corruption Day, observed annually, on 9 December.

The Anti-bribery and Anti-corruption e-learning module was launched with a roadshow across all our UAE offices.



Roadshow as part of the launch of the Anti-bribery and Anti-corruption e-learning module



Setting the “Tone at the top” for e&’s new values from key leaders pictured, (right to left): Group Chief People Officer, Ali Al Mansoori; Group Chief Legal and Compliance Officer, Brooke Lindsay; Group Director of Ethics, Culture and Integrity, Brian Kings Muriithi Kimathi

Pillar 3 | Operating responsibly

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10 Data privacy



Privacy and data protection is integral to our organisational ethos, influencing business decisions and spurring innovation. To live to this ethos, e& has made significant progress in setting data privacy standards in the UAE and internationally. The launch of the Group Data Privacy Programme pilots across several business units was a key milestone. By adopting a centralised and comprehensive strategy, we have assessed and bridged compliance gaps across diverse business models and risks, effectively providing benchmarks to other business units that are amidst the process of implement the Group Policy.

As e& significantly helps to shape the UAE's society, our efforts in privacy and data protection while fostering innovation and growth position us at the forefront of transforming the UAE into a leading global data hub, adhering to top international standards. The roll-out of this unified data protection programme enhances e&'s reputation and cements our status as a regional and global leader. Our uniform strategy minimises regulatory risks and boosts consumer confidence in our commitment to data privacy."

Brooke Lindsay

Group Chief Legal and Compliance Officer

Definition of material matter:

To us, data privacy means taking care of the confidentiality and integrity of all personal information we hold, including that of our customers, employees and business partners. It encompasses the responsible and lawful handling of data, ensuring compliance with privacy laws, regulations and industry standards.

Why it is material to e&:

Data privacy is material to e& due to the increasing legislative landscape in the markets we operate in and the importance of the expanding digital information process. As a technology company, e& recognises the trust placed in it by customers and stakeholders and understands that the responsible management of data is essential for maintaining that trust.

Type of impact:

Positive impacts include fostering trust among customers and stakeholders, while potential negative impacts could involve breaches leading to reputational damage, financial loss and legal consequences.

Value chain impact:

- Upstream
- Operations
- Downstream

Key stakeholders:

- Customers
- Employees
- Business partners
- Shareholders
- Local and national authorities

Policies:

- [e& Group Data Protection Policy](#)
- [e& Supplier Code of Ethical Conduct](#)
- [e& Code of Conduct](#)

Our management approach

At e&, we are committed to upholding the highest standards of data privacy while navigating the dynamic landscape of digital connectivity. As we expand our operations across diverse geographies, we acknowledge the need for strategic agility in navigating both emerging and established data privacy regulations. In several regions, including the UAE, our activities are governed by multiple regulatory bodies. In the UAE, we comply with the Data Protection Law (Federal Law No. 45), which draws inspiration from the GDPR, as well as regulations from the TDRA overseeing the use of consumer data within the telecommunications sector.

Following the launch of our Group Data Protection Policy last year, the full implementation programme was rolled out during 2024, including toolkits and pilots for all e& verticals, in alignment with data protection policies. As a comprehensive framework approved by our Audit Committee and Board of Directors, this policy is applicable across all e& operations worldwide and is complemented by local policies tailored to specific regulatory requirements in our operating markets.

Our Group Data Protection team, composed of data privacy experts with GDPR expertise and positioned within the Legal and Compliance

→ Continues

Pillar 3 | Operating responsibly

Data privacy continued

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department, exemplifies our proactive commitment to data privacy. Acting as a second line of defence, this specialised team manages regulatory risks, engages with authorities, fosters a culture of compliance, and supports employees with data privacy-related inquiries. Under the leadership of the Group CEO and the Board, who actively promote a culture of privacy, the team ensures alignment with evolving regulations while safeguarding our commitment to data protection across all operations.

The Group Data Privacy team provides a direct communication channel for OpCos to report any privacy and information security incidents, including those with suppliers. The team manages and supports the investigation of any incident to assess its risk level and guide any measures that need to be taken.

From an operational perspective, each of our OpCos implements robust technical and security measures to safeguard personal data from unauthorised access, misuse, or loss. The Group Legal and Compliance team establishes comprehensive privacy standards and policies, guiding operational companies to implement necessary controls centrally. Group Legal and Compliance further train OpCos privacy leads to ensure ongoing awareness and programme monitoring. In the UAE, we ensure that data privacy training is readily available to all employees, reinforcing a culture of awareness and responsibility.

At e&, we prioritise data protection by evaluating supplier and partner privacy practices from the RFP phase through a detailed assessment. As detailed in our Supplier Code of Conduct, all suppliers must demonstrate robust data protection policies or adhere to ours, signing tailored agreements before onboarding. Regular audits ensure ongoing compliance, safeguarding data integrity and security in all interactions.

Additionally, our commitment to data governance is integrated into our Enterprise Risk Management (ERM) system, ensuring that the latest developments are aligned with our strategic priorities and reported transparently in our Integrated Report.

Progress in 2024

We successfully advanced our Data Privacy programme, building on the robust framework established with the launch of the Group Data Privacy policy in 2023. The rollout of this programme enabled us to evaluate compliance levels across our business units and verticals while identifying data protection compliance gaps. Through the completion of the Data Privacy discovery phase for the programme pilot, we delivered actionable insights and a strategic roadmap for implementation and remediation across Etisalat Service Holding (ESH), HR, and Finance. Furthermore, we developed and began implementing a tailored data protection framework for e& Money to align with the applicable regulatory requirements, ensuring compliance and bolstering trust in our financial operations.

As we expanded our footprint into Central Europe following the acquisition of a controlling stake in PPF, we acknowledge the EU regulations and are working with our international OpCos to ensure the alignment of our programmes with stringent data protection standards and regulations in these markets.

Furthermore, our role as a pioneer in AI adoption in the UAE brought unique challenges, requiring us to address data protection concerns associated with AI applications and the development of numerous AI use cases (For more on our approach to AI, [click here](#)). Additionally, the Data Privacy programme's rollout required careful prioritisation and alignment to close identified compliance gaps within the tight timelines set in collaboration with our business units.

Our efforts in enhancing data privacy have been recognised with significant accolades. We received the Outstanding Project Contribution Award (OPCA) for the launch of the first comprehensive group-wide data privacy policy. Additionally, we were honoured with the prestigious Technology, Media, and Telecommunication In-House Team of the Year award at the Asian Legal Business (ALB) Middle East Awards, reflecting our leadership in data privacy and regulatory excellence.

Data privacy summary

Our performance	2021	2022	2023	2024
Number of data breaches	0	0	0	0

Future focus

In 2025, we will finalise the rollout of e&'s Data Protection Programme assessments across all remaining verticals and business units where we have a controlling interest. This initiative will include implementing compliance tools and frameworks for HR, Finance, Operations, ESH, e& Money, and eVision, ensuring robust data protection measures across our organisation.

Simultaneously, we will strengthen regulatory compliance support for privacy and data protection in our artificial intelligence initiatives, both within the UAE and in international markets, including the EU. As we expand into countries with advanced data protection frameworks, we will establish a unified global approach that fosters innovation and economic growth while prioritising consumer privacy.

Looking further ahead, as the UAE's general data protection law continues to support its vision as a hub for innovation and data, we are positioned to play a pivotal role in balancing privacy safeguards with technological and economic advancements. By 2030, we will work towards enabling targeted, adaptive regulations to address the complexities of emerging technologies. Through close collaboration with legislators and policymakers, we aim to advance e&'s position as a global technology leader while upholding our commitment to safeguarding data privacy.

[→ Continues](#)

Pillar 3 | Operating responsibly

Data privacy continued

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Strengthening data privacy:

A unified approach at e&

A holistic framework for data protection

As a global technology leader, e& prioritised the development and rollout of a unified Group Data Privacy Programme to ensure robust data protection across its operations. This initiative marked a significant step in standardising privacy compliance assessments, fostering a culture of privacy, and addressing the unique needs of various business units and verticals, including ESH, Group HR, and Group Finance. By adopting a holistic approach, we established a foundation for consistent privacy governance across diverse risk profiles and business models.

Aligning with best practices

Implementing a centralised privacy programme presented an opportunity to align our organisation with international best practices and enhance stakeholder confidence. However, achieving this required overcoming challenges such as accommodating varying business needs, addressing compliance gaps systematically, and ensuring minimal disruption to operations. The complexity of managing data privacy across a global organisation necessitated innovative solutions to balance regulatory requirements and business efficiency.

Implementing solutions for enhanced privacy

We adopted a unified, centralised methodology for the privacy pilots, incorporating legal design principles and

leveraging a streamlined compliance framework. The introduction of a comprehensive dashboard enabled seamless communication and tracking of privacy compliance progress, identifying areas of best practice and improvement. This approach minimised disruption, enhanced awareness through privacy mapping, and delivered actionable insights for a cohesive organisational response to data privacy needs.

In addition, our commitment to safeguarding data privacy includes a rigorous evaluation of the privacy practices of suppliers and partners. This commitment is embedded in our procurement processes, starting at the Request for Proposal (RFP) phase, where a comprehensive privacy assessment questionnaire ensures alignment with our high standards for data protection.

Building trust through innovation

The successful rollout of the pilot programme significantly advanced compliance levels, reinforced e&'s reputation as a regional leader in data privacy and strengthened organisational defences against regulatory risks. By embedding privacy as a core cultural value, e& established trust with stakeholders, minimised risks of breaches, and positioned itself as an innovation-driven, privacy-conscious organisation. This initiative demonstrated our unwavering commitment to setting new standards in data protection.



Pillar 3 | Operating responsibly

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11 Cybersecurity

At e&, cybersecurity is not just a function, it is a strategic imperative. We are committed to upholding the highest standards of cybersecurity excellence, driven by a robust governance framework, continuous innovation, and a proactive approach to mitigating emerging threats. By leveraging cutting-edge technologies, fostering strategic partnerships, and actively engaging with the UAE Cyber Security Council, we are dedicated to creating a secure and resilient digital ecosystem for the UAE and beyond, empowering individuals and businesses to thrive in a connected world.

Definition of material matter:

Cybersecurity is a foundational aspect of e&'s operations, encompassing measures and practices aimed at safeguarding the Company's digital assets, infrastructure and customer data from cyber threats.

Why it is material to e&:

Cybersecurity is material to e& due to the increasing frequency and sophistication of cyber threats in the digital landscape. As a technology company, e& understands that the cybersecurity of its systems directly impacts the trust and confidence of its stakeholders.

Type of impact:

Positive impacts include a secure digital environment, safeguarding customer trust and protecting critical business operations. Potential negative impacts involve the risk of data breaches, financial loss and reputational damage.

Value chain impact:

- Upstream
- Operations
- Downstream

Key stakeholders:

- Customers
- Employees
- Business partners
- Shareholders
- Community
- Local and national authorities

Policies:

- e& UAE has a policy framework encompassing over 35 policies covering all security domains
- [e& Supplier Code of Ethical Conduct](#)
- [e& Code of Conduct](#)

Our management approach

Cybersecurity is crucial for fostering a secure and trustworthy digital ecosystem in e& and is deeply embedded within our corporate governance framework. Our Corporate Information Security Steering Committee (CISSC), chaired by the UAE CEO, provides strategic oversight and ensures the continuous enhancement of our cybersecurity posture. This executive-level body, comprising of members from across our verticals and functions (e& UAE, e& enterprise and e& life), addresses a comprehensive range of security domains, encompassing cybersecurity, physical security, personnel security, business continuity management (BCM), and governance. Our OpCos are independently governed.

We maintain rigorous information security policies, subject to regular review by the CISSC, that address critical areas such as risk management, data security, asset management, access control, and physical security. Our Chief Technology and Information Officer (CTIO) plays a pivotal role in reinforcing our commitment to cybersecurity excellence.

Our internal security Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) reflect our unwavering focus on mitigating cyber risks. We strive for near-zero security incidents that impact our business operations, 99.9% uptime

→ Continues

Pillar 3 | Operating responsibly

Cybersecurity continued

for our security defences and controls, and minimal critical and high-severity vulnerabilities. The effective management and continuous improvement of our cybersecurity capabilities are paramount, enabling us to respond swiftly to emerging threats and maintain a secure and resilient operating environment.

Cybersecurity awareness and training is provided to e& employees periodically to keep them updated of the emerging technologies' cyber threats and risks, along with updates in the Information Security policies and legal/regulatory updates.

We adhere to the principles of ISO 27000:2013 and maintain PCI DSS accreditation for select activities, demonstrating our commitment to industry best practices and regulatory compliance.

Progress in 2024

We solidified our position as a leader in cybersecurity through a series of significant initiatives throughout the year. We continued to address emerging trends in cybersecurity by enhancing our Secure Access Service Edge (SASE) capabilities to support the Zero Trust model, ensuring secure access to resources and protection against evolving threats in a distributed, cloud-driven environment.

We further launched the Scam Advisor service, in collaboration with the UAE Cyber Security Council, empowering UAE citizens to validate the legitimacy of websites and safeguard themselves against cyber scams. Recognising the evolving threat landscape, we designed a

private 5G Security Operations Centre tailored for government customers, providing advanced threat detection and response capabilities.

To bolster our cybersecurity offerings further, we built a secure, air-gapped cloud environment for government customers to host critical infrastructure, ensuring the highest levels of data security and resilience. Additionally, we introduced tailored DDoS protection services for government customers, mitigating the risk of disruptive cyberattacks.

We conducted mandatory cybersecurity training for new joiners and existing staff who have not yet completed the training, featuring a stringent passing score requirement of 80%. We achieved a 96% completion rate for our internal security training in 2024. In addition, regular roadshows and quarterly phishing exercises further contributed to enhancing employee awareness.

Recognising the need for effective collaboration to deliver world-class cybersecurity, we pursued strategic partnerships to advance cybersecurity capabilities. We collaborated with leading global Telecom providers to develop a Telecom-based Large Language Model (LLM), leveraging the power of AI to enhance cybersecurity solutions. Additionally, our partnership with AWS enabled us to offer sovereign cloud services to government and regulated entities, meeting the stringent security and compliance requirements of these sectors.

Our commitment to cybersecurity excellence was recognised by the UAE Cyber Security Council through various accolades for our contributions, including the Scam Advisor service, bug bounty programmes, and threat intelligence services.

Future focus

Looking forward, we will be offering more innovative and comprehensive cybersecurity services. These services will equip organisations to navigate the complexities of an evolving digital landscape securely.

To build this area of expertise, we will continue to enhance our security capabilities in line with emerging technologies and transformations. We aim to strengthen our cybersecurity capabilities to address evolving threats and challenges, including quantum security and other emerging risks. Our focus will remain on staying adaptive to technological advancements, ensuring regulatory compliance, fostering innovation, and building strong partnerships.

Our performance	2021	2022	2023	2024
Number of attempted cyber attacks (mio)	8.4	65.7	105.9	205.628
Number of actual cyber attacks	0	0	0	0
Percentage of employees trained on cybersecurity (%)	70	80	95	96

Robust vulnerability management for enhanced cybersecurity

We have established a well-defined, organised, and integrated vulnerability management programme. This programme enables us to periodically detect, assess, and mitigate vulnerabilities within our products and services, ensuring a robust and secure environment.

Our Cybersecurity Risk Management framework aligns with the UAE Information Assurance (IA) Regulation, directives from the Telecommunications and Digital Government Regulatory Authority (TDRA), ISO 27005 standards, and our Enterprise Risk Management framework. This framework provides a robust foundation for the continuous assessment of our services, enabling us to effectively manage emerging cybersecurity risks that could potentially impact our business.

To safeguard our ecosystem from evolving cybersecurity threats, we have implemented a comprehensive suite of detective and preventive security controls and measures. The effectiveness of these controls is rigorously reviewed and validated on a periodic basis.

Pillar 3 | Operating responsibly

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12 Responsible AI



This year, our organisation pioneered the launch of one of the region's most comprehensive Responsible AI Frameworks, marking a decisive shift in how artificial intelligence is built, deployed and governed. This framework creates a blueprint for balancing technological innovation with risk management. By building a strong governance structure, fostering collaboration across teams, and working with global tech leaders, we have shown that adopting transformative AI can go hand-in-hand with staying accountable, being transparent, and driving positive change for society."

Dena Almansoori
Group Chief AI & Data Officer

Definition of material matter:

We are committed to developing and using AI applications responsibly and safely to create sustainable value for our stakeholders. To mitigate biases and prevent unintended harm, we manage AI-related risks and opportunities in accordance with local and global standards, prioritising fairness, transparency, and accountability.

Why it is material to e&:

A sustainable digital transformation requires responsible AI governance. It is becoming increasingly important to develop and implement AI solutions that stakeholders trust, are designed to treat all people fairly, perform reliably, and make a positive impact at scale as AI technologies are adopted across our markets.

Type of impact:

Enhance customer trust through responsible AI solutions, improve service quality, and foster innovation that benefits society. Through responsible AI we mitigate bias, privacy breaches, and non-compliance with regulations.

Value chain impact:

At every stage of the AI lifecycle, the Responsible AI Framework integrates governance and accountability:

- Upstream: Vendor partnerships, technology procurement, and data sourcing
- Operations: Internal processes, system optimisation, and employee tools
- Customer-facing AI services, support systems, and digital solutions

Key stakeholders:

- Customers
- Employees
- Business partners
- Shareholders
- Community
- Local and national authorities

Policies:

- [e& Group Responsible AI Framework](#)
- Group Enterprise Risk Policy
- [e& Group Data Protection Policy](#)

Our management approach

Our Responsible AI Framework is the primary governance document that guides AI development and deployment across the organisation. It encompasses eight core responsible AI principles, risk assessment protocols, a robust governance structure, detailed implementation guidelines, and clear stakeholder responsibilities.

The Responsible AI Framework was built on a robust governance foundation by bringing together experts across multiple domains, including legal, compliance, enterprise risk, technology, IT, data security, data privacy, and artificial intelligence. The new AI Governance Steering Committee has been established to identify, assess, and mitigate risks throughout the AI use case lifecycle from ideation to implementation. The committee conducts a comprehensive AI risk assessment in collaboration with use case owners to address potential risk appetite considerations. By aligning mitigation strategies and continuously reviewing AI governance across the organisation, we can identify gaps, improve, and adapt to evolving standards while maintaining internal strategic alignment. Our AI initiatives are innovative and responsibly governed through this structured approach to ensure transparency, accountability, and trust.

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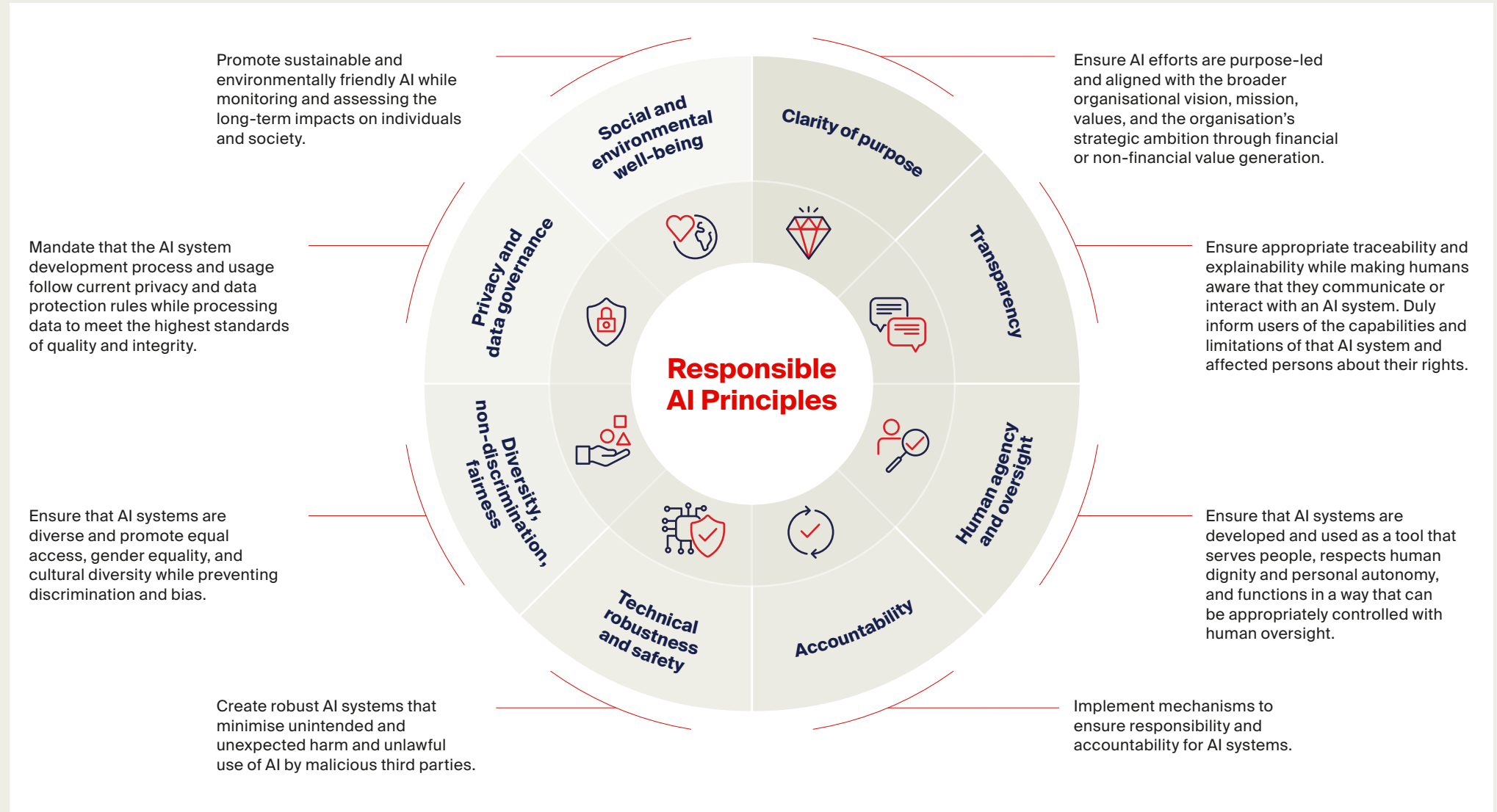
Pillar 3 | Operating responsibly

Responsible AI continued

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Responsible AI principles

The following 8 principles guide the approach to AI risk management within e&:



Pillar 3 | Operating responsibly

Responsible AI continued

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Progress in 2024

Through the launch of our Responsible AI Framework in 2024, we marked a turning point in our commitment to deploy AI responsibly in line with global best practices. It reinforced our leadership position in ethical technology deployment by establishing comprehensive guidelines for managing AI risks at both enterprise and operational levels.

Navigating challenges and complexity

AI technology is rapidly evolving, and we must navigate its complexity while maximising the social benefits. As a result, significant coordination was required to ensure adoption of the Responsible AI framework across e& without disrupting our operational momentum. The launch of the framework allowed for strengthened operational resilience in AI development and enabled informed decision-making, fuelling a balanced approach to innovation.

In terms of the broader e& Group governance structures, AI is part of the “Data & AI” principal risk as per the publicly available disclosure (refer to the risk management section within the annual report for further details). As a principal risk, the Group Enterprise Risk Management Committee is responsible for governing our position on risk appetite, the effectiveness of the control environment and the progress made in our strategies and mitigations, while ultimate oversight lies with the Board Risk Committee.



Strengthening global collaboration

Aside from our internal progress, we actively participated in global efforts, notably developing GSMA's “Navigating the Path to Responsible AI” initiative, supporting their Maturity Roadmap and assessment tools to improve our practices. In addition, being part of the World Economic Forum's “AI Governance Alliance”, further exemplifies our dedication to collaboration, shaping the future of AI responsibly, ensuring its potential is harnessed with integrity and accountability. These efforts strengthened our role as a pioneer in responsible AI governance.

We collaborated with IBM to deploy a pioneering, end-to-end, multi-model Generative AI governance solution, announced at the 2025 World Economic Forum in Davos. This collaboration intends to enhance our AI governance framework to promote compliance, oversight, and ethical practices across its growing AI ecosystem, reinforcing e&'s commitment to establishing robust governance, risk management, and regulatory oversight across its AI usage. The new AI governance solution introduces advanced features like automated risk management, compliance monitoring, and real-time performance analysis.

This will enable e& to mitigate risks, detect biases, and address regulatory standards throughout the entire AI model lifecycle – from development to implementation as well as to detect issues like bias and drift early, allowing for corrective action and ethical AI practices.

Future focus

In 2025, we will continue to integrate our Responsible AI Framework and its principles into daily operations to ensure employees and stakeholders understand and effectively implement its guidelines. We aim to improve governance mechanisms, develop advanced monitoring capabilities, and align assessment protocols with global standards in order to achieve excellence in AI risk management. In addition, we will invest in targeted training programmes to equip our teams with the skills and tools they need to lead responsible AI initiatives.

Our ambitions extend beyond internal adoption. By sharing best practices and collaborating with industry partners, we will continue to position ourselves as regional leaders in responsible AI, promoting technological innovation while maintaining the highest ethical standards, and demonstrating how responsibility can coexist to drive progress by fostering a culture of ethical AI practices.

As we move forward, we envision developing responsible AI solutions that address global challenges, promote sustainable development, and enhance digital inclusion. As a long-term commitment, we aim to lead the industry in deploying AI technologies that uphold the highest ethical standards while delivering meaningful societal benefits.

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Pillar 3 | Operating responsibly

Responsible AI continued

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AI4SD:

Leveraging AI for sustainable development and humanitarian impact

Harnessing AI for crisis response

Our Climate & Natural Disaster Crises (CNDC) platform demonstrates how AI can enhance earthquake disaster response through real-time analysis and monitoring. We deployed our AI-powered platform in the aftermath of the devastating Türkiye-Syria earthquake. This platform leveraged AI to assess the scale of the disaster and generate critical insights, demonstrating how AI can drive proactive measures in disaster recovery and identify high-risk areas requiring immediate intervention. These insights informed strategic post-earthquake responses, optimising aid distribution and emergency efforts while also identifying key gaps and areas for improvement to mitigate similar challenges in the future.

Challenges and opportunities in disaster analytics

The challenge in managing and analysing vast unstructured public source data from local and international sources can lead to delayed response times and fragmented decision-making. However, our AI-driven approach transforms these challenges into opportunities by rapidly processing multiple data streams, extracting actionable insights, and providing a unified view of the crisis landscape.

This enables faster, more coordinated humanitarian responses while ensuring critical resources reach those most in need.

A collaborative, AI-driven solution in partnership with Datalyticx for analytics expertise and the UNDP for strategic coordination, our AI-powered platform is designed to enhance resilience against climate-related challenges like floods, earthquakes, and droughts. Utilising AI-driven insights and data visualisation tools, we analyse post-disaster trends, conduct sentiment analysis, and assess evolving humanitarian needs. This empowers emergency teams and policymakers to optimise aid distribution, prioritise rebuilding efforts, and fortify resilience planning for future crises.

Impact and global recognition

Our AI platform achieved global prominence when presented at the UN General Assembly in 2024, reinforcing e&s position as a leader in AI-powered humanitarian solutions. By bridging technology with human needs, we demonstrated how AI can drive meaningful, scalable impact in the face of adversity.



Group Chief AI & Data Officer, Dena Almansoori, presents AI4SD at UNGA79 in New York

As a result of this platform, urgent humanitarian needs can be identified in realtime, lives can be saved, communities can be protected, and resilient mechanisms can be built to cope with natural disasters such as floods and earthquakes more quickly and effectively. This is a powerful example of how we can use artificial intelligence to do good and make a difference.

Pillar 3 | Operating responsibly

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13 Sustainable supply chain



At e&, responsible supply chain management is a business imperative that reflects our commitment to sustainability, ethical practices, and creating value across every level of our operations. By working collaboratively with our partners and leveraging innovative initiatives like e& Project Life, we are shaping a supply chain that drives environmental stewardship, supports economic growth, and upholds the highest ethical standards.

As a company committed to creating sustainable value, we are proud to lead by example in promoting trust, transparency and accountability across our procurement and supply chain at e&.”

Saeed Alzarooni
Chief Procurement Officer

Definition of material matter:

A sustainable supply chain refers to the integration of environmentally and socially responsible practices across the procurement and distribution processes. It involves minimising the environmental impact, ensuring ethical sourcing and fostering positive social outcomes within the supply chain.

Why it is material to e&:

Sustainable supply chain management is critical for e&, as it aligns with the Company's commitment to corporate responsibility beyond its own operations. Ethical and social sourcing coupled with environmentally conscious practices contribute to a sustainable and resilient business model.

Type of impact:

Actual positive impacts include a reduced carbon footprint, ethical sourcing and community development. Potential negative impacts involve reputational damage due to unethical practices within the supply chain.

Value chain impact:

- Upstream

Key stakeholders:

- Customers
- Employees
- Business partners
- Community

Policies:

- [e& Supplier Code of Ethical Conduct](#)
- [e& Occupational Health and Safety Policy](#)
- [e& Group Environmental Management Policy](#)
- [e& Third-Party Risk Management Policy](#)

Our management approach

We have a vast and highly integrated supply chain that plays a critical role in ensuring business continuity and delivering value to our stakeholders. Our supply chains primarily focus on procuring technology and telecommunications equipment, software solutions, and professional services essential to our operations. We remain committed to strengthening our relationships with our suppliers and vendors, which range from small and medium-sized enterprises to global multinationals.

We are dedicated to supporting the UAE's strategic goals by prioritising local suppliers and sourcing locally whenever feasible. Sustainability in our supply chain is driven through a collaborative, cross-functional effort involving our Legal and Compliance team, Enterprise Risk Management function, Sustainability team, and Procurement department, which leads these initiatives.

Progress in 2024

We made significant strides in advancing ESG performance across our supply chain. A key focus has been encouraging suppliers to move beyond baseline standards in ESG and ICV metrics, addressing the challenge of fostering proactivity in their sustainability efforts.

Central to these advancements was the completion of Phase 1 of e& Project Life, a transformative initiative

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Pillar 3 | Operating responsibly

Sustainable supply chain continued

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launched at COP 28 to enhance supplier sustainability practices. Additionally, we made progress in developing our green procurement platform and utilised EcoVadis evaluations to assess and engage suppliers more effectively.

In addition to these efforts, we further integrated ESG considerations into our procurement practices, reflecting our commitment to building a responsible and sustainable supply chain. By maintaining our Supplier Code of Ethical Conduct and strengthening due diligence processes, we ensure supplier alignment to ethical and social practices.

Part of Project life launched at COP 28 to demonstrate e&'s commitment to sustainability, we set targets to enhance our procurement systems and processes with the goal of reducing Scope 3 emissions by 25% by 2030 in alignment with the UAE's emissions reduction ambitions. As part of our Climate Transition Plan, we assessed our top ten suppliers and their existing carbon reductions targets – seven of which are SBTi aligned. Engaging with these suppliers will support us in our emissions reductions journey.

Supplier Code of Ethical Conduct

e& has a Supplier Code of Ethical Conduct that sets out responsibilities and obligations towards ethical procurement and human rights. It promotes responsible management of social, ethical, and environmental issues, setting stringent requirements for suppliers. Significant negative social impacts identified include human rights risks such as forced

labour, child labour, and human trafficking. The Code emphasises non-discrimination, fair treatment, and safe working conditions, ensuring all employees are treated with dignity and respect. It enforces zero tolerance for bribery, corruption, and money laundering, requiring strict compliance with relevant laws. Additionally, it mandates secure handling of confidential and customer data to protect privacy. Environmental responsibility is promoted through sustainable practices and minimising harmful emissions. An anonymous reporting mechanism addresses grievances and unethical behaviour, ensuring accountability and protection for whistleblowers. These measures aim to mitigate negative social impacts and uphold high ethical standards throughout e&'s supply chain.

The Supplier Code complements our e& Code of Conduct for e& employees, and ensures that our suppliers consistently apply, and align to, the same standards and values, to support the communities in which we work and reduce the risk of unethical or illegal conduct in our supply chain. As part of our procurement process, all suppliers are required to acknowledge receipt and must agree to abide by our Supplier Code of Ethical Conduct. Where a third party shares their own Supplier Code of Conduct, e& undertakes a desktop review and if the terms are acceptable, we confirm mutual acknowledgement, by sharing a copy of our own robust e& Supplier Code of Ethical Conduct. We further provide training to third parties and business partners on a risk basis, in

combination with our robust onboarding due diligence process.

All our suppliers are expected to ensure their own suppliers and subcontractors are made aware of the principles of our Supplier Code of Ethical Conduct when undertaking any work or providing any product or service for or on behalf of e&.

Our Supplier Code of Ethical Conduct is available here.

Supply Chain Due Diligence

Protecting our brand and reputation is central to e&'s operations, as such we carry out a rigorous registration, selection, and due diligence process before engaging any supplier. We collaborate closely with our suppliers to ensure that they meet our standards across their operations and supply chains.

To facilitate the selection, review, approval, and monitoring of business partners, we have implemented a robust interaction framework involving our procurement, compliance, and business teams. This approach is a critical element in managing risk across e&'s supply chain.

Our supplier risk assessment and due diligence process leverages advanced third-party screening technology from a globally recognised provider. This system automatically monitors all registered suppliers daily, providing updates and warnings on potential risks, including ESG factors. The platform offers insights into lawsuits, negative media coverage, and other key risk categories, ensuring comprehensive oversight.

In 2024, 100% of our suppliers within our system underwent risk assessments using this technology, covering a spend of over AED 15 billion across North America, Europe, the MENA region, and Asia. For high-risk suppliers identified through screening, we engage further via detailed due diligence questionnaires and reserve the right to conduct audits under contractual compliance clauses.

During this year, the Compliance team conducted two internal audits to enhance supplier processes and ensure alignment with the Supplier Code of Ethical Conduct, focusing on addressing gaps and implementing improvements. Additionally, one external audit was conducted as part of third-party screening using Dow Jones Risk and Compliance, ensuring high-risk suppliers were thoroughly evaluated.

To date, all strategic suppliers have been assessed, with most of our Group suppliers covered by this system. Our Afghan subsidiary employs the same screening technology, and we plan to increase synergies across the Group over time. Upholding a zero-tolerance policy for human rights violations within our value chain, we reserve the right to terminate relationships with suppliers that fail to comply with our standards or take corrective action within agreed timelines. In 2024, no suppliers were terminated due to environmental or social violations.

In Country Value (ICV) Programme

Aligned with the UAE Federal Government's initiative to enhance economic performance and support

local industries, we evaluate suppliers based on their ICV, which reflects their presence and contributions within the UAE. This approach redirects a larger portion of spending into the national economy, fostering growth and development.

Last year, the Ministry of Industry and Advanced Technology (MolAT) introduced green ICV criteria within the National ICV Programme to promote sustainability across supply chains. As the first company in the UAE to adopt the green ICV evaluation process, e& took a leading role in integrating environmental practices into procurement.

Building on this progress, we increased our ICV target from 75.71% in 2023 to 82.89% in 2024, including contributions through the green ICV framework. This reinforces our commitment to supporting the UAE's economic and environmental priorities while driving sustainable growth within our supply chain.

Achieving CIPS Certification

e& has achieved a significant milestone by earning the prestigious Corporate Ethical Procurement and Supply certification (CIPS), marking its unwavering commitment to embedding ethical practices across its procurement operations. Every procurement and supply management professional at e& completed rigorous training and assessments covering critical areas such as fraud prevention, anti-bribery and corruption, environmental responsibility, and legal and social accountability.

→ Continues

Pillar 3 | Operating responsibly

Sustainable supply chain continued

Performance evaluation and recognition

At e&, sustainability is a collaborative effort with our partners. We actively recognise and reward high-performing suppliers through an exclusive annual awards ceremony dedicated to celebrating their contributions. This event highlights our belief that every collaborator is a vital partner in our shared success. Tied closely to performance evaluations, the ceremony reinforces the importance we place on the meaningful role our suppliers play in advancing our sustainability goals.

Future focus

In 2025, we will begin implementing phase 2 of e& project life, focusing on achieving the objectives outlined in phase 1 and deploying responsible sourcing capabilities at scale. This is part of our wider goals to achieve 25% emissions reduction in scope 3 emissions across the Group by 2030 as part of our journey towards supporting the UAE's net zero 2050 vision.

Our performance	2021	2022	2023	2024
Total procurement spend (AED million)	11,700	12,932	13,708	15,432
Percentage of procurement spend spent on local suppliers (%)	86	83	81	83
Total new suppliers		310	457	488
Proportion of new and existing suppliers acknowledging our Supplier's Code of Conduct (%)			100	100
Proportion of spend covered by our screening process, including ESG considerations (%)*			100	100
Proportion of strategic suppliers covered by our screening, including ESG considerations (%)*		n/a our assessment process was initiated in 2023	100	100
Number of strategic suppliers covered by our screening process, including ESG considerations, considered high risk, under ongoing remedial process*			8	45
Number of strategic suppliers, covered by our ESG screening-terminated due to ESG risks	0	0	0	0

* The screening is carried out to identify ESG risks as well as other risk categories including, but not limited to: Sanctions, Enhanced Country Risk, Adverse Media, human rights, modern slavery and environmental issues in the value chain.

e& Project Life:

Pioneering responsible sourcing through EcoVadis

At e&, sustainability is embedded as a core principle, driving a new way of working that aligns with our ambition to lead in responsible sourcing through digital transformation. To achieve this vision, we are collaborating with suppliers to reduce carbon emissions across our supply chain by 25% by 2030, as part of our SBTi-validated scope 3 target. Additionally, we aim to drive circularity through local initiatives such as *Make it in the Emirates*, limit our impact on nature and biodiversity, promote diversity and inclusion, uphold human and labour rights, and strengthen business resilience through improved risk management and external disclosures.

In 2024, we completed phase 1 of project life, setting a strong foundation for achieving our responsible sourcing objectives. This phase outlined our roadmap for the next three years as we work towards our 2030 emission reduction target.

Phase 1 focused on several key milestones. We defined our responsible sourcing vision and strategic roadmap, embedding ESG principles into procurement policies and processes. We also advanced supplier engagement on ESG by launching awareness sessions and enhancing internal collaboration to improve supplier relationships. Importantly, we began onboarding

suppliers onto the EcoVadis platform to enable responsible sourcing through integrated digital tools such as EcoVadis and SAP Ariba. Further steps included finalising our responsible sourcing target operating model, which is undergoing review by senior management, and assessing how to integrate ESG KPIs into procurement and contracting systems as part of our scaled digital transformation.

By building a strong foundation with project life, we are driving meaningful progress in responsible sourcing, aligning our supply chain with our sustainability ambitions, and reinforcing e&'s position as a leader in sustainable procurement.



Project life is a complete end-to-end programme aimed at driving sustainability with suppliers and making e& a leader in responsible sourcing, powered by business reinvention and the digital transformation."

Saeed Alzarooni,
Group Chief Procurement Officer and e& sponsor of e& project life

Pillar 3 | Operating responsibly

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13 14 15

14 Human rights

At e& we are committed to respecting and upholding human rights in our operations and value chains. Guided by global principles, we aim to create lasting impact by fostering dignity, equality, and responsible business practices wherever we operate.

Definition of material matter:

To us, human rights means protecting and respecting the rights and dignity of those affected by our activities or business relationships, in compliance with applicable legislation and in line with our policies.

Why it is material to e&:

Respecting and upholding the rights of our stakeholders is not just a legal obligation, but a moral imperative for e&. It is embedded in our core values, reflecting our commitment to conducting business responsibly and contributing positively to the communities we serve. It is essential to securing their trust and our licence to operate.

Type of impact:

Positive impacts include creating an inclusive workplace, strengthening human rights in our supply chain and supporting local communities and customers by enabling them to indirectly fulfil certain basic rights through access to connectivity. On the flip side, human rights infringement or violation may erode stakeholders' trust and our business reputation, impacting our bottom line.

Value chain impact:

- Upstream
- Operations
- Downstream

Key stakeholders:

- Customers
- Employees
- Business partners
- Shareholders
- Community
- Local and national authorities

Policies:

- [e& Supplier Code of Ethical Conduct](#)
- [e& Code of Conduct](#)

Our management approach

Our commitment to human rights is governed by our code of conduct and supplier code of ethical conduct, ensuring full alignment with applicable laws and ethical practices. As signatories to the UN Global Compact, we uphold its principles, which are rooted in the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, the International Labour Organisation's Declaration on Fundamental Principles and Rights at Work, the Rio Declaration on Environment and Development, and the United Nations Convention Against Corruption. These frameworks guide our efforts to embed respect for human rights across all aspects of our operations and value chain.

Progress in 2024

In 2024, we took a significant step in advancing our commitment to human rights by aligning with the UN Guiding Principles for Business and Human Rights. Furthermore, we initiated a review of our approach to human rights and conflict minerals in late 2024. Our goal is to publish our review in 2025, engaging with stakeholders from across the business whose contributions are pertinent. Oversight and approval will be provided by the Sustainability Committee, as we reaffirm e&'s dedication to respecting and promoting human rights across all our operations.

→ Continues

Pillar 3 | Operating responsibly

Human rights continued

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While our human rights programme continues to evolve, we believe our existing policies already address key aspects of this commitment. Our recently developed group data protection policy underscores our promise to handle the information of employees, customers, and stakeholders with the highest levels of care and confidentiality, in line with applicable data privacy laws. Additionally, our code of conduct and Supplier Code form the foundation of our human rights efforts, addressing critical issues such as non-discrimination, equal opportunities, modern slavery, child labour, human trafficking, harassment, health and safety, and respectful online behaviour. (For more, see our DEI section on page 24 and ethical business practices on page 43)

Operating across diverse geographies and regulatory frameworks, we respect local laws while upholding fundamental rights, including freedom of organisation and collective bargaining in countries like Pakistan and Egypt, where such rights are recognised. To further embed these principles, we have enhanced our due diligence processes. Through our third-party risk management system, which includes risk-based due diligence for a range of ESG risks, including human rights, modern slavery and environmental issues in the value chain, we now assess suppliers for social risks. Our procurement, compliance, and business teams work collaboratively to evaluate, monitor, and manage supplier relationships in alignment with our risk management standards.

We maintain a robust approach to ensuring compliance with our supplier code of ethical conduct reserving the right to terminate partnerships with suppliers who fail to address reported breaches within agreed timelines. As per training, procurement teams engage with suppliers on human rights best practice and any corrective actions required.

Further upstream, we have integrated ESG due diligence into our merger and acquisition activities, explicitly incorporating human rights considerations. We are committed to strengthening this process in 2025 based on our experiences and the insights gained so far. Through these actions, we remain steadfast in our mission to uphold human rights throughout our value chain, with a range of ongoing continuous improvement initiatives and efforts to benchmark and integrate new global frameworks and update existing commitments to reflect evolving norms moving forward.

Future focus

In 2025, we will deepen our efforts to integrate sustainability into the core of our operations, reflecting our commitment to advancing human rights across the Group. Recognising the importance of respecting and promoting human rights as a fundamental aspect of responsible business, we are taking concrete steps to formalise our approach.

A key focus for the coming year will be the development of a Group human rights policy and programme to outline further our commitments across all aspects of our operations and value chain. Building on our existing codes of conduct, this policy will provide a structured framework to guide our practices, consider global standards – including but not limited to the UN Guiding Principles for Business and Human Rights and the OECD Guidelines for Multinational Enterprises – and reinforce our accountability in this critical area.

These human rights efforts contribute to our sustainability commitments, including operating responsibly, maintaining ethical and transparent business practices, and being a diverse, inclusive and ethical employer. Overall, the policy will further strengthen our governance, reduce risks, and ensure that we contribute positively to the communities we serve.

Pillar 3 | Operating responsibly

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13 14 15

15 Responsible commercialisation

At e& UAE, enhancing the customer experience remains a cornerstone of our commitment to delivering excellence. By focusing on proactive solutions, innovative services, and streamlined operations, we have achieved significant progress in addressing customer needs while reducing pain points. Our targeted efforts have not only improved key performance metrics but also strengthened trust, reduced complaints, and optimised service delivery.

Definition of material matter:

Responsible commercialisation pertains to our commitment to providing exceptional experiences across our diverse range of services while communicating and marketing them in a fair and ethical way in line with applicable standards. This commitment is instrumental in fostering long-term relationships and sustaining our reputation.

Why it is material to e&:

Responsible commercialisation is crucial for e& as it directly influences brand loyalty, customer retention and competitiveness. It serves as a key performance indicator reflecting the success of e& in meeting customer expectations.

Type of impact:

Positive outcomes involve increased loyalty and positive word-of-mouth, while negative impacts include dissatisfaction, reduced loyalty and potential harm to the brand. The opportunity lies in enhancing customer satisfaction for increased loyalty and business growth, while the risk is in neglecting these issues, leading to churn and potential harm to the brand reputation.

Value chain impact:

- Operations
- Downstream

Key stakeholders:

- Customers
- Employees
- Business partners
- Community
- Local and national authorities

Our management approach

At e&, earning and maintaining the trust of our customers is fundamental to our business success, and we are committed to doing so with integrity. We prioritise product and service quality as the foundation of our customer-centric approach, ensuring transparent communication, fair practices, and enhancing the ease with which our customers can engage with us. Led by our Chief Customer Experience Officer, with the dedicated support of our customer experience team, our approach is tailored to the unique market dynamics, customer segments, and regulatory standards across our Group and operating companies.

Progress in 2024

During 2024, e& UAE made significant strides in enhancing customer experience, as evidenced by substantial improvements across key performance indicators. Its Net Promoter Score (NPS) rose by approximately 21% over the previous year, reflecting stronger customer satisfaction and trust. This progress also contributed to a 59% reduction in escalated consumer complaints within the last 12 months.

Our achievements are a testament to our strategic commitment to excellence in customer service, spearheaded by our award-winning initiative, change factory. This initiative represents our dedication to actively listening to and integrating

[→ Continues](#)

Pillar 3 | Operating responsibly

Responsible commercialisation continued

customer feedback, thereby enhancing the overall customer experience. Our proactive measures have yielded strong results, including a significant 31% reduction in top-of-the-funnel volume and a 21% decrease in agent-level interactions. These improvements reflect our success in pre-emptively addressing customer issues, thereby refining their product and service experience.

e& UAE's commitment to customer experience and service excellence was recognised through 13 regional and international awards in 2024, including five prestigious honours at ICXA'24 and top accolades at the Customer Centricity, USB Forums, and Asian Experience Awards.

Addressing customer complaints

e& prioritises customer satisfaction and strives to address any negative impacts promptly and effectively. We actively gather customer feedback through various channels, including our dedicated 101 hotline, the change factory initiative, and analysis of Net Promoter Score (NPS) insights and customer verbatim comments. This data allows us to identify and address both immediate and underlying issues that may be impacting our customers.

In the change factory, when a customer concern arises, we take swift action to investigate and resolve the issue. This may involve providing timely communication to the customer, offering appropriate solution or compensation, and implementing corrective measures to prevent similar issues from occurring in the future. The change factory initiative is our customer feedback management system that tracks and monitors customer satisfaction across digital apps, retail sales, and all other touchpoints, including TDRA, the regulatory body in the UAE. The system enables us to prioritise issues based on the volume and severity of impact on customers, determine the root cause and address the most critical issues through targeted improvement projects.

Customers may report concerns, issues, or complaints through our 101 hotline. Through this dedicated hotline, e& ensures that customers can easily reach out for support regarding any aspect of their service, including disruptions, customer service issues, or concerns about electromagnetic fields from telecom equipment.

By actively listening to our customers, analysing their feedback, and

implementing proactive solutions, we continuously strive to enhance the overall customer experience and build strong, long-term relationships with our valued customers.

Future focus

In 2025, we will focus on elevating customer experience by driving transformative initiatives that strengthen our service offerings and operational excellence across both consumer and business segments. Our strategy is designed to position e& as the UAE's most loved and trusted brand while setting a global benchmark for excellence. Key priorities will include addressing mobile technical issues to ensure seamless user experiences, implementing pre-emptive care for fixed-line services to prevent disruptions, and enhancing broadband connectivity to deliver exceptional speed, reliability, and performance.

We will also prioritise creating meaningful improvements in customer interactions and value delivery. In our upcoming strategy, we aim to drive a seamless onboarding process that ensures new customers enjoy a smooth and satisfying first 100 days, while our digital platforms will enhance value perception by making technology work smarter for users. Reinventing our customer service proposition will allow us to deliver innovative, responsive, and personalised support that distinguishes e& from competitors. Through these efforts, we aim to lead the regional market while ultimately securing a position among the world's top 10 companies for customer experience.

Our performance	2021	2022	2023	2024
Number of customer complaints	762,876	534,797*	411,752	389,387
Percentage of customer complaints resolved (%)	96	97	94	91
Percentage of first call resolution (%)	85	87	73**	78**

* 2022 data restated to include full year data
** FCR measurement methodology has been changed in 2023 and cannot be compared with previous years

Fostering a customer-centric culture

e& implemented several innovative initiatives to enhance customer experience, improve operational efficiency, and strengthen our commitment to customer satisfaction. These initiatives demonstrate our dedication to continuous improvement and leveraging technology to address customer needs effectively. Three notable examples are the virtual technician programme, the customer experience enhancement programme (CEEP), and the CX safer app.

Virtual technician programme

We implemented the virtual technician programme, which was designed to promptly resolve customer issues and concerns while minimise the environmental footprint of in-person technician visits. This initiative allows customers to receive expert technical support via video calls. In 2024, we achieved an impressive first contact resolution (FCR) rate of 64% on average. As a result, we prevented 13,664 unnecessary technician dispatches, enhancing efficiency and reducing environmental impact.

CEEP

We focus on proactively identifying and addressing the root causes of recurring mobile technical issues through the Customer Experience Enhancement Programme (CEEP). By analysing customer data and conducting in-depth investigations, we have been able to implement targeted solutions to prevent these issues from occurring in the future. This proactive approach has resulted in a 30% year-on-year reduction in technical repairs, improving customer satisfaction and reducing operational costs.

CX safer app

We empower our employees to act as customer experience ambassadors through the CX safer app, enabling them to submit complaints on behalf of their friends and family. This initiative fosters a strong sense of ownership and empowers employees to directly contribute to improving customer satisfaction. The app has demonstrated a high-resolution rate for customer complaints submitted by employees, showcasing the effectiveness of this employee-centric approach to customer service.

